

PRAYER SCHOOL MANUAL



CHRISTIAN PRAYER SCHOOL
MUSIYE
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INTRODUCTION

In this age and time, God, the possessor of heaven and Earth, has chosen to pour out the spirit of intercession on His church worldwide. Nigeria has in the last 2-3 decades benefited immensely, albeit quietly from this move of God. Intercession is not an end in itself, but a means through which God will achieve His planned spiritual revival for Nigeria, Africa and the whole world.

Intercessors for Nigeria is one of the para-church groups that has been drinking deep from this fountain of God's latest move. With increasing knowledge and better spiritual understanding of intercession, spiritual warfare and deliverance of people and the land came a burden to share these truths with the body of Christian Nigeria.

Emeka Nwankpa, Steve Okitika, Uduak Udofia, Ntiense Ubon-Israel and Kole Akinboboye who make up the leadership of the Intercessor for Nigeria have led several prayer Conferences and workshops in all parts of Nigeria in the last twenty years with the primary aim of teaching Intercession and Spiritual warfare including the deliverance of the land.

As a result of increased awareness on Intercession, there arose a need for deeper teachings and better equipment of the newly raised intercessors. This need gave birth to Prayer Schools in Nigeria under the auspices of intercessors for Nigeria. Segun Olanikpekin who is currently based in Kenya with a charge to each intercession in East Africa and Southern Africa is one of the Prayer School teachers and first Prayer School coordinator in Nigeria. B.U.Bassey took over the coordination of Prayer schools in Nigeria where Segun left for Kenya.

As Segun departed Nigeria for Kenya in 1995 it became obvious that more men and women whom God has gifted in the teaching of Intercession should be identified to assist in spreading the burden of God's move in Nigeria.

The Prayer School Manual contains some of the core teachings given in the various prayer schools in Nigeria. The Prayer School teachers who are the main contributors to the Manual held three retreats/workshops in Calabar, Nigeria in the months of March, April and May 1998 in order to put together,

in a written form, some of the teachings in this Manual, subsequent editions shall include those topics not presented in the current issue. The manual is primarily intended to assist Prayer school Teachers to put across to God's people consistent and balanced teachings on the various topics based on our present understanding of the subjects. Apart from three who lay no claim to any superior theological theories or presentation. The focus here is to present Biblical Truths as revealed by the Holy Spirit in a simple and practical form that could easily be understood by Christians. The truths are to be applied to real problems and situations that confront us on a daily basis. We recognize that these teachings could be used by students of the Bible and Pastors to improve on their knowledge of the different subjects. However, the emphasis here is not on improved head knowledge on the subjects of Intercession but on actual praying. The target is to raise praying men and women not those who are very knowledgeable on the subject of Prayer.

In 1998 over 90 Prayer Schools were held in different cities and in all parts of Nigeria to share these truths. In 1999 over 60 Prayer Schools have been planned are currently being executed in Nigeria.

We give God all the glory for the profound effect these teachings have had in transforming in a verifiable manner, the lives of many Christians and above all changing the spiritual atmosphere in Nigeria. We have an understanding in the spirit that is to be done before God's purposes is achieved. We must therefore preserve until God brings to pass in totality all that has burdened our hearts to pray for.

Engr. B.U. Bassey

Principal (Coordinator) of Prayer Schools

THE MINISTRY OF INTERCESSION

What is Intercession?

Among other definitions, intercession is the holy, believing, persevering prayer that pleads with God on behalf of a person people, place (or circumstance) which desperately needs God's intervention.

Why do we intercede?

- i. To break the bands of weakness (Is 58:6)
- ii. To over throw the captor.(Jer 50:33-34)
- iii. To set he captives free. (Is 49:24-26)
- iv. To deal with ancestral covenants and curses (Ex 20:1-5, Zech 7:14)
- v. To heal the land of curses, pollutions and defilements (Gen 3:17, Lev 18:24, Zech 7:14)
- vi. To bring restoration(Joel 2:25-27)
- vii. To bring God's counsel to pass (Ps 149:6-9)
- viii. To exalt God

Examples of Intercessors

- i. Moses – Ex 32:1-33
- ii. Abraham – Gen 18:17-33
- iii. Daniel – Dan 9:1-20
- iv. Nehemiah – Neh 1:1-11
- v. Jesus – Jn 17:1-26
- vi. Paul – Eph 1:16-23, Col 1:9-12

Results of intercession

- i. God is glorified
- ii. The body of Christ(Church) is strengthened
- iii. God's work prospers

Qualities of an intercessor

- i. Pure and Holy life (Is 52:11, Lev 19:2)
- ii. Obedient to God (Dt 28:1, 15)
- iii. Humble heart (Ja 4:10, 1 Peter 5:6, Ja 4:7-10)
- iv. Burdened heart (Neh 1, Fan 9)
- v. Honest and sincere dispositions (Phil 1:21-25, 1 Sa 12:3-5)

Hindrances to intercession

- i. Sin – Prov 14:34, Ps 66:18
- ii. Faithlessness – Heb 11:6
- iii. Disobedience – 1 Kings 13, Lev 10:1-2
- iv. Unforgiveness – Math 6:14-15
- v. Hatred – Math 5:22-24
- vi. Impurity
- vii. Hypocrisy/ Deceit – Ps 144:11
- viii. Keeping the accursed things – Josh 7:1
- ix. Idolatry – Ex 20
- x. Wrong foundations – 1 Cor 13:11

Areas of Intercession

- i. For sinners 2 Tim 2:1-4, Ps 22:27
- ii. For weak Christians – Gal 6:1
- iii. For the church – John 17
- iv. For the land – Dan 9
- v. For enemies – Lk 6:27-29
- vi. For the afflicted – 1 Tim 2:1-3
- vii. For the Ministry of the world – acts 14:3, Eph 6:19
- viii. For Israel and Jerusalem – Ps 122:6-9, 125:5, 128:6

Conclusion

Intercessors are genuinely born again Christians who are burdened by the Holy Spirit to intercede.

REDEMPTION AND THE INTERCESSOR

Introduction

It has been said that the ministry of intercession is a redemptive one. The intercessor must tirelessly play this role as he intercedes for the land, people or institutions as the case may be.

God has prepared His people for all times so that the work of redemption would not be frustrated in any generation. Christ is the author of redemption (Col 1:14). The intercessor is an agent of redemption. He has been redeemed by God as king and priest through the sacrifice of Jesus Christ (Rev 5:9-10). The intercessor fulfils this role of redemption as he

- (i) Takes responsibility – spiritually and even sometimes practically to reconcile all things to God
- (ii) Repents identificationally:
- (iii) Perseveres in intercession
- (iv) Roots out wickedness
- (v) Plants righteousness
- (vi) Builds faith through God's word in a person, place, people or institution

Provision for the Redemptive Role of the Intercessor

Text: 2 Cor 5:17-21

- (i) The new birth offers the spiritual qualification (17)
- (ii) God, in Christ, reconciled us to himself and gave us the ministry of reconciliation. He is thus in redeeming the lost to himself through Christ.(18)
- (iii) When He reconciled the world through Christ to Himself, he did not impute the sin of the world on the forgiven sinners. He has given us his word, His son Christ in us (19).
- (iv) As ambassadors, we have become extension of God's hands.(20)
- (v) Our righteousness must be Christ standard (of God and clearly expressed in our relationships). (21).

Biblical examples of redemptive roles

- (i) Call of Abraham - Gen 12:1-3
- (ii) The Ark of Noah - Gen 6:17-22

Through the redemptive roles of each of these, God raised a nation through them to continue His programme.

- (iii) The Passover Exodus .12:1-4
 - (a) God raised a firstborn for himself
 - (b) The lamb per household expresses the price of redemption and points to the willing identification with God's salvation plan for mankind.
 - (c) Christ became this lamb and who accept Him become partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light (Col 1:12).

What redemption roles – Rom 8:18-25

This begins with the individual:

1. One must be redeemed to seek the redemption of others (v.19)
2. One must understand the purpose of one's redemption.
3. One must seek to fulfill your redemptive purpose in Christ.
4. One must realize that all creatures are waiting for their redemption
5. Having a redemptive burden – (Nehemiah 1:3-4)
6. Hearing from the Lord - (Psalms 32-8)
7. Seeking the Lord by prayer – (Jeremiah 29:12-13)
8. Standing in the counsel of the Lord – (Jeremiah 23:18)
9. Carrying out prophetic warfare/ actions – (Isaiah 62:10)
10. Obedience to the voice of the Holy spirit – (John 10:1)
11. One must pass through purification – (Malachi 3:1-3)
12. One needs to possess the fear of God – (Malachi 3:5)
13. Commitment to your salvation – (Mark 10:27)

Ignorance of these truths brings limitations in fulfilling God's divine destiny for your life and can also make you irrelevant to the church and to your generation.

Sign of redemption

Effortlessly living out the word of (Matthew 4:4).

Manifesting the power of God's word. (John. 12: Mark. 16:15-18 Jeremiah 5:14:23:29).

Liberty in prayer (1 Thessalonians 5:17)

Free and two way communication with God (Ezekiel 1:1-4)

Conclusion

God's plan is to reconcile all things to himself. Man is God's agent for that work of redemption and reconciliation. The man (intercessor) must first experience the redemption of God and then seek the same for others (the people, the land and the institutions).

FASTING AND PRAYER

What is fasting?

1. Fasting is the total concentration unto God by abstaining oneself from food, drinks, sleep and other natural pleasure for a period of time.
2. Fasting can also be defined as going without food and drink for a period.

Praying/ fasting

Prayer needs fasting for its development. There are certain situations that cannot give way except by prayer and fasting.

Types of fasting.

- (i) Absolute fast(dry fasting, no water)-Jesus, Matthew 4:1-2
- (ii) Total fast (water can be taken) – Daniel 9:3-6
- (iii) Partial fast (abstaining from certain food) Luke 18:12 ; Daniel 1:8-12

Who should fast?

All believers are supposed to fast. Fasting is a must for every child of God. Particularly an intercessor. Mathew 6:16 Isaiah 58:5-9

Reasons for fasting

- (a) Fasting humbles the soul before God. –Psalms 35:13 ii Chronicles 7:14
- (b) Fasting chastens the soul- Psalms 69:1
- (c) Buffets the appetite and flesh- 2 Sam 12:16-23- mark 4:1-11
- (d) Shows earnestness before God. – 1Corinthians 7:5
- (e) To loose the chains of injustice/ wickedness Isaiah 58:6-8
- (f) For repentance Joel 2:12-13
- (g) To destroy mountain, - Esther 4:16
- (h) To cast out certain demons Mark 9:29
- (i) To assist you in prayer Matthew 17:16-21
- (j) To commission men for ministry Acts 13:2 Acts 14:23
- (k) To express grief and patience 1 Kings 21:27, 1 Sam 31:13
- (l) Certain need requires fasting: Ezra 8:21

Case of people who fasted in the Bible

- (i) Ahab - 1Kings 21:27-29
- (ii) Judah - 2 Chronicles 20:1-3
- (iii) Ezra - Ezra 10:6-17
- (iv) Men of Nineveh - Jonah 3
- (v) Jews - Esther 4:1-3, 9:1-3
- (vi) David - 2 Sam 3:35, ps35:13, 69:10
- (vii) Daniel - Daniel 9:3, 20-22
- (viii) Annah - Lk 2:37
- (ix) Churches - Acts 13:1-3
- (x) John's disciples - Mt 9:14-15
- (xi) Jesus - Mt 4:1-11
- (xii) Paul - acts 9:9-17
- (xiii) Moses - Dt 9:9, 18,25-29
- (xiv) Joshua - Ex 24:13-18, 32:15
- (xv) Elijah - 1 Kings 19:7-18

Note: You are supposed to find out the men in the Bible who fasted

How do we fast?

- (i) Avoid so much talking (it pollutes and weakens you)
- (ii) Avoid strenuous jobs
- (iii) Do a lot of prayer and Bible study. You can even read Christian literature
- (iv) Be conscious of the fact that
 - (1) You are in the presence of God
 - (2) You are waiting on the Lord
- (v) Do not talk about it so much.
- (vi) Be conscious of certain places you go because you could be provoked.
- (vii) Dress properly and anoint your body so that people will not notice easily that you are fasting.

Preparation before embarking on a fasting

- (i) Decide with God the duration of the fast.
- (ii) Receive from God the spiritual strength and stamina to sustain you.
- (iii) Sanctify the fast
- (iv) Do not broadcast the fast.
- (v) Listen to God as you study the Bible and as you pray.
- (vi) Always use a reference to find out Bible passages related to your needs.
- (vii) Expect when mandated to fast, always determine the purpose of the fast.
- (viii) Your prayers must go with a lot of confessions and repentance.
- (ix) Draw a prayer plan.
- (x) Agree with your spouse if you are married in the area of sex.
- (xi) Do not work up yourself if you are going on long fast
- (xii) If your house is not convenient relocate to another place preferable a Christian camp.
- (xiii) If you are in the house, avoid receiving visitors.
- (xiv) If you are going on a long absolute fast, take water.

- (xv) If you eat so much and you are preparing for a long fast, start few days before the fast to reduce your eating habit.

Breaking your fast

- (i) Make arrangement on what to break the fast with.
- (ii) Get food and fruit rich in nutrients.
- (iii) Do not rush into eating food.
- (iv) Drink water fast (warm water).
- (v) If you went on long fast do take solid food like 'Eba' until after several days.

Conclusion

All believers are expected to fast but there are no set rules and regulations as to duration and frequency. A servant is not above his master. If Jesus fasted, we also ought to fast. Do not fast to impress Men or God. Do not allow your fasting to degenerate to starvation. Remember that Jesus commanded us to fast because the bridegroom has been taken. Remember that occasionally you will feel dizzy and even like dying but go ahead. You will not die. Most fasts are usually difficult within the first three days thereafter you regain strength and spiritual favor. Resist every temptation to stop, or even break when it is not up to the time you had been led by the Holy Spirit to do a long fast.

GENERATIONAL SINS AND THEIR IMPLICATION

Introduction

Transgressions of laws, commandments and ordinances bring the punishment of God, not only on the transgressors but upon their offspring, family, community, city or even nation. The effect runs from one generation to another Ex 20:5

Example of generational sins

- (i) Idolatry – Ex 20:1-4
- (ii) Adultery/ Fornication – Gen 38:1-30, 2 Sam 11:2-5
- (iii) Murders/ other forms of blood guiltiness 2 Sam 21:1-5
- (iv) Sin that produced generational consequences.
 - a) Gen 9:25 Ham saw the father's nakedness rather than covering it, he mocked and earned a curse which has affected his descendants till today.
 - b) 2 Kings 5 Gehazi lusted after Naaman's wealth against the advice of Elisha and earned for himself and his descendants leprosy.
- (v) Gen 38:1-30 (The immoral sin of Judah)
- (vi) David was also affected – 2 Sam 11:2-5
- (vii) @ Sam 17-19 Civil war because of adultery.

Effects of generational sins

- (i) Promotes the ministry of Satan in the land e.g. stealing, killing and destruction. Jn 10:10a, 8:37-47
- (ii) Delays the programs of God. Deut 23:1-3, Matt 1:1-6
- (iii) Strifes, wars and contention – 2 Sam 11:2-5, 1 Kings 11:1-3
- (iv) Violence 2 Sam 13:22-29, 15:1-37
- (v) Unsolvability mistakes – Ez 44:10-16, 23, 24
- (vi) Rebellion 1 Kings 2
- (vii) Spread of the worship of idols – 1 Kings 15:25-26

Dealing with the problem of Generational sins.

- a) Every minister of deliverance must realize that all creation waits for the manifestation of the sons of God. Rom 8:19-23

- b) God loves the world and still calls us to save the helpless john 3:16, Hosea 3:1-3
- c) The generational sin must be dealt with on the basis of the new birth. John 3:3, Gal 2:19-20 (Salvation)
- d) Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law. Gal 3:10-13

Steps in dealing with the problem

- Confessing of the sins and repentance.
- Renouncing the sins, effects, token, etc.
- Atonement by the blood of Jesus Christ.
- Break their speaking in the sun, moon, stars
- Prophetic healing, restoration and blessing.

Raise altars on the person, place or thing. Anointing with oil can be made if led to do so. Intercession, prayers etc. must continue until God establishes the person, place or thing.

Conclusion

Jesus has been made a curse for us thereby providing a sue way out for our deliverance from generational sins and their consequences.

COVENANTS

Introduction

A covenant is a formal or informal agreement that is legally binding between two parties. It is written, signed and sealed or unwritten, has tokens by which it is established and has a trans-generational effect with terms and conditions. There are covenants between God and man, man and man, man and the Devil, which means that covenants are both positive and negative. Covenants can be entered into knowingly and unknowingly.

1. A positive covenant: Those covenants that God is a party to, they are established and work on the principles of God's word and His righteousness.
2. Negative covenants: Covenants with the Devil. They are established and work on the principles of the kingdom of Darkness and its wickedness.

1. Covenants between God and man.

- (a) God and Abraham (Gen 17:6-8, 9-14: 15:7-16: Gen 22:15-18)
- (b) Melchizedek and Abraham (Gen 14:17-20: Heb 7:1-10)
- (c) God and Isaac (Gen 26:24-25)
- (d) God and Israel (Ezek 36:26-38)
- (e) God and David (Ps 89:3, 2 Sam 7:4-12)
- (f) Jesus and the disciples for the church (1 Cor 11:23-26)

2. Covenants between Man and Man

- (a) David and Jonathan – 1 Sam 18:3-4
- (b) David and Elders of Judah & Benjamin – 2 Sam 2:4
- (c) Children of Israel and the Gibeonites Jos 9:15-16
- (d) A conspiracy under oath to kill Paul – Acts 23:12-13
- (e) Ruth and Naomi – Ruth 1:16
Joshua with the people of Israel

3. Covenants between Devil and Man

Usually Satan is in the habit of copying whatever good that God does but pervert the same against the purposes of God.

(a) Covenants with death and hell. Is 28:14-18

Examples

- (i) Body incision for tribal marks
- (ii) Body incision on women looking for children
- (iii) Body incision for protection and business
- (iv) Body incision for traditional healing

(b) Covenants with water spirits. Is 47:1-end: Rev 18:2-10

- (i) Washing in water through the help of a witch doctor
- (ii) Attending white garment churches and receiving treatment of any kind from them.

1. How covenants are entered into:

- (a) At altar
- (b) Through marriage. Ps 106:28

Note: Marriages are transacted at the altar and covenants are entered into there.

Every covenant is established on an altar and sustained at the altar.

2. How to break Negative Covenants

This kind of covenants can be broken or destroyed but there are principles that will help in dealing with it. These principles apply both on the land, family and individuals at any given time.

- (i) Identification – You need to identify these covenants by asking relevant and related questions.
- (ii) Repentance to God over these sins. (Dan 9:1-end: Ezra 9:1-end)

- (iii) Renunciation follows after repentance. Renouncing the vows, the promises, the agreements, the tokens, that strengthens the covenants.
- (iv) Use the blood of Jesus to bolt out all the handwriting of devil by these covenants on the land against the family or the individual. Col 2:14
- (v) The judgment that the enemy has written against the person in question should be destroyed. (Col 2:15-17).
- (vi) It is important to get at the Elders of the family or community in question where possible for repentance on a representative level.
- (vii) By the blood of Jesus, reconcile everything back to God, the people, the land, their resources and the fullness thereof. Col 1:20
- (viii) Healing should be ministered to them.

Conclusion

For several generations, these truths have been hidden until recent time, and the enemy has capitalized on it to weaken the church. We need therefore not only to teach it but to be used as instruments to minister same. May His grace be sufficient to us.

THE CHALLENGES OF INTERCESSION

Introduction

Intercession has been explained to mean the holy, believing, persevering prayer that pleads with God on behalf of a person, people or circumstance which desperately needs God's intervention. We have also discovered that through intercession:

- i. The bonds of wickedness are broken. (Is 58:6, Est 3-8, Acts 12:1-12:21-23)
- ii. The captor is overthrown. (Jer 50:33-34)
- iii. The captives are set free. (Is 49:24-26, Is 61:1-3)
- iv. Ancestral covenants and curses are dealt with. (Ex 20:1-6, Zech 7:14, Is 28:14-28:15-18)
- v. The land is healed (2 Chron 7:14: 2 Kings 2:19-22)
- vi. We bring restoration (Joel 2:25-27)
- vii. We establish God's counsel (Ps 149:6-9)
- viii. We glorify and exalt God (John 14:13, 1 Kings 18:39)

Intercession is thus a redemptive ministry and one cannot enter into it if the errors he sees in others are still in him. (Jn 8:1-11). The Pharisees could not stone the woman caught in adultery because they themselves were not without sin. Jesus could set the woman free because He was without sin.

- Are you as an intercessor recording these results?
- Are you disabled because of sin?

The challenges of Intercession

To get the result enumerated above, one must pay a price as follows:

- * Having a staying power in the place of intercession. (Lk 18:1-5)
- * Having the faith that transcends the odds of the times.

As attractive and as close to God as the ministry may be, it is confronting Christians with fresh options. The measure of success of any intercessor would depend on how he responds to these options.

New options

Far from being born again and disconnected from ones foundation, the intercessor in the days ahead will need:

- i. Ability to stay above sin to be able to minister forgiveness or redemption – Jn 8:1-11
- ii. A constant return to the Lord (Hos 6:1-3; 14:1-9)
- iii. Constant covenant renewal (2 Kings 23:1-3)
- iv. Purity of heart (Matt 5:8; Is 52:11b) and cleanness of hands (Ps 24:3-5; 15:2)
- v. Honesty and diligence in service (Gen 24; Is 12:3-5)
- vi. Humility (1 Pet 5:6), Holiness (Lev 19:2; 20:26), Righteousness (Gen 6:9, 15:6; Prov 28:1)
- vii. Faith in God (Eph 6:16; Heb 11) and faithfulness to the commission.

Conclusion

The challenge of intercession requires those who will refuse weakness and discouragement. (Heb 12:12-13). The results will not fail, so let us also not despair. Return to the Lord your God. Enter into His priestly covenant and remain there. (Mal 2:4-7)

THE SPIRIT OF ANTI-CHRIST

Reading Matt 24:3-13 1 John 2:18-19

Introduction

It is important to understand that what happens in the physical are controlled in the realm of the spirits. These are spirits that detect the event in the physical and that affects human beings and the land. Spiritual skills help us to be able to plant the glory of God in the land.

The spirit that must be spiritually dealt with is the spirit of Anti-Christ (I.e. Opposer o Christ). It is satanic spirit.

Duty of the spirit of Anti-Christ

- To oppose anything that exalts Jesus Christ as the Lord
- To bring Division and disunity in the body of Jesus Christ.
- It opposes the truth, holiness, prayer, God's word and true worship.
- Promotes idolatry and occultism
- Aims at leading people astray and sending them to hell instead of heaven.

Effects of the spirit of Anti-Christ

John 10:10 – To steal kill and destroy

Effects include

1. Denial of Christ, 1 John 2:22, Matt 10:33;
2. Deceit 2 Cor 11:13-15; Matt 24:5; 2 John 7
3. Promotes false prophets and false teachers: Jer 2:8; Zeph 3:4; 2 Peter 2:1 Ez 22:23-39
4. Promotes iniquity Rom 1:28-32, Gal 5:19-21, Rom 3:21-5, 5:19-21(5)
5. Promotes Backsliding among believers. Matt 24:17; Rom 2:4
6. Brings darkness (covering) upon the church, family, nation and people. Is 25:7
7. The spirit that worketh disobedience is the spirit of Antichrist.
8. Promotes lawlessness, violence, oppression in the land and in governance.

9. Promotes wickedness and manifests in witchcraft and marine spirit
10. Uses lies and propaganda. Rev. 13:5.
11. Spirit of flamboyancy 1 Sam. 13:1-3.(display, showing off)

Things that enhance / promote the Anti-Christ

- 1) Absence of Spiritual leadership. Exod. 32:1-2.
- 2) Evil Association (Compromise). 1 King 11:4.
- 3) Worldly success 2 Chron. 25:2, 14.
- 4) Absence of Spiritual Watchmen (i.e. Intercessors) Ezek. 22:30.
- 5) Lack of Spiritual Insight. John 6:63 -66.
- 6) Love of the World. 2 Tim. 4:10.

Example of Activity of Antichrist: 1 Sam. 17:38-51

- The Spirit that works in Goliath is the Spirit of Anti-Christ.
- Goliath opposed and defied the name of the Lord.
- Proud, arrogant and boastful
- Goliath used the arm of the flesh.

Why David could beat goliath

1. David knew God and was in good relationship with God.
2. He was concerned about the state of God's people
3. Saw the battle as the Lord's
4. Exercised absolute dependence on God.
5. Drew strength from the Lord
6. Was full of God's spirit, therefore able to fight.
7. David exercised prophetic utterance 1 Sam 17:47-48

What must intercessors do with the spirit of Anti-Christ?

Intercessors

- Must be like David
- Must be provoked by things that defy the Lord's name.
- Must be concerned by the state of the people.
- Must be spiritually sensitive.

- Receive strategy from God to deal with Goliath (i.e. the Anti-Christ of our times)
- Fight against the spirit of anti-Christ from heaven
- Deliver the church from this spirit through intercession.

Dealing with the spirit of Anti-Christ

1. Truly dedicate self-unto God and be adequately sealed with the Holy Spirit
2. Give yourself to the truth from God
3. Ask for strength and strategy from God.
4. Ask for anointing to fight against lawlessness and wickedness
5. Ask God to contend against false prophets and teachers
6. Fight against the oppose of truth
7. Deal with the spirit of lies in the church
8. Practice prophetic praying or utterance

IDOLATRY

Introduction

Idolatry is a system devised by the devil to control the land, family and people. It constitutes abomination, contention and rebellion against God. It also promotes false worship, deception, animal and human sacrifices. (Deut. 4:15-20, 23-24; Ex. 20:1-5). Any worship of a deity outside the God of heaven through Jesus Christ is idolatry (1 Tim. 2:5-6). Anything esteemed higher than God becomes an idol.

Eph. 5:5. The basis of all idolatry is marriage covenant with demons, Hosea 2:2-3.

God sees idolatry as spiritual prostitution.

Idolatry came into existence as a result of Satan's rebellion against God, the five Al. wills of the devil in Isa. 14:12-17 and the fall of man to sin encouraged and strengthened idolatry (Gen. 3:1-7).

The Nature of Idols

- (i). They are insatiate (cannot satisfy). Deut. 4:28
- (ii). Perishable (Isa. 40:20, Jer. 10:11)
- (iii). Helpless (Isa. 45:20, Jer. 10:15)
- (iv). Unworthy of Worship (Acts. 17:29)
- (v). Degrading (Rom. 1:22-23)
- (vi). Works of error (Jer. 10:15)
- (vii). Works of human hands (Ps. 115:4)
- (viii). Insensitive (Ps. 115:5-8)

Example of Idolatry

Ex. 32:1-6, Ps. 105:19-20	-	Moulded calf
Nu. 25:2	-	Sacrifices
Judge. 3:7	-	Backsliding
1 Kings 13:30-33	-	Shrines, temples and high places
1 Kings 16:31	-	Ungodly marriages

2 Kings 17:11-12 - Idolatrous worship/ service (21:21, Da. 3:7)

Deut. 18:9-12 - Abominable traditions and practices

Idolatrous practices.

(i). Blood shedding - Witchcraft, wars, riots, accidents, abortions, etc. (Deut. 18:10-14; Ps. 106:34-40).

(ii). Lev. 19:26-32

(iii). Wickedness

(iv). Libation - Jer. 44:24-26

(v). Festivals - Ezek. 16:18-25

(vi). Raising of sacred trees and graven images (Ps. 78:58).

How Does God View Idolatry?

Idolatry is forbidden by God (Ex. 20:4); He hates and abhors idolatry and commands that we should flee idolatry.

(i). Exod. 20:4

(v). 1 Jn. 5:21

(ii). Exod. 34:17

(vi). Lev. 26:1

(iii). Deut. 7:25

(vii). Deut. 11:16

(iv). Isa. 42:8

Biblical curses of idolatry: *Ps. 97:7; 16:4; Isa. 42:17.*

Consequences of Idolatry

(i). Idolatry brings a curse (Deut. 27:15; Ps. 16; 7 Isa. 42:17). You acquire the nature of whatever you worship. (Ps. 106:19-20, Rom. 1:28-32)

(ii). The judgment of God on idolaters is until the fourth generation (Exod. 20:5).

(iii). Idolatry is hereditary (Heb. 7:7-10). It brings demons to the blood.

(iv). It brings the land and people under bondage through the raising of altars and high places. When a land is in bondage nothing works there. (Lev. 18:24-30).

- (v). Idolatry blinds men to the truth of the gospel of Jesus Christ by bringing a covering over a people or an environment (Isa. 25:7; 2 Cor. 4:3-4).|
- (vi). Idolatry is a major opposition to the gospel of Jesus Christ.
- (vii). Those who bring idols will sacrifice their children and bring death to their young ones. (Ps. 35:42)
- (viii). God will fish and hunt out idolaters for punishment. (Jer. 16:16-18)
- (ix). Idolatry destroys a nation very fast (Jer. 16:19-20)

Curses Proclaimed Over Idolatry:

- (i). 1 Kings 22:13
- (ii). Deut. 28:15- end.
- (iii). Ps. 2:12
- (iv). Jn 3:36
- (v). Rom. 1:18
- (vi). Eph. 5:8

Solution to Idolatry:

- (i). Pray until the people are led into repentance (Zech 12:10). Take responsibility over the land and bring its sins under the light of repentance. (Neh. 1:5-11; Dan. 9:3-19; Jonah 3:5 -10, 1 Pet. 1:18-20).
- (ii). Address the covenants that were made with idols
- (iii). Find out the idols worshipped and repent of them by names, the covenants made and break them specifically. Speak to the idols on behalf of your people. Men have authority over where they live. (Gen. 1:28; Luke 10:19; Jer. 10:11, 15).
- (iv). Make atonement with the blood of Jesus Christ and use the blood to break the covenants. (Zech. 13:1-2. Rev. 5:9-10).
- (v). Engage, in spiritual warfare. Address as many demons as you know by name and classify those you do not know. Bind and cast them out. Bind also the princes of darkness operating in the land. (Ps.149:5-9).
- (vi). Enter into Prophetic prayer for the land and people. Speak the truth and say what the people should begin to do (Zech 8: 16- 17; Jer. 1:10).
- (vii). Replace the covenants you have dealt with positive ones. If it involves prophetic action don't go alone unless specifically instructed by the Holy Spirit.

Conclusion

God hates idolatry with a perfect hatred. The hold of idolatry upon a man, family, tribe, land or nation can only be broken through the power of Jesus Christ.

ALTARS ON THE LAND

Introduction

Altars are indispensable places of worship. From earliest times they served as means by which things offered in sacrifice were brought into contact with or otherwise transferred to the deity of the worshippers. The idea of altars was initially started by God, (Gen. 8:20). It is to be noted, however, that like most other things genuinely started by God, Satan provides a counterfeit.

Altars on the land are very significant in spiritual warfare because they not only bring a covering over the land, but also determine the spirits that control the land and only bring a covering over the land, but also determine the spirit that control the land and invariably also the people that dwell in the land.

Many of the problems in most African families, villages and communities arose because of the ancient satanic altars raised by the forefathers. In the light of these, a good Working understanding of altars, their significance and applications becomes crucially important and necessary for every prayer student.

Purposes of Altars

Serve the following purposes:

- (i). As a place of sacrifice. Deut. 27:4-7, Matt. 5:23
- (ii). As a place of dedication. Gen. 28:18-19;
- (iii). As a place of covenant making. Gen. 28:20-22; Gen. 8:20; Gen. 9:17
- (iv). As a place of communion with spirit beings. Gen. 8:20, 9:8; Num. 23:1

Types of Altars

Altars can broadly be segregated into two major classes:

- (i). Altars of God - Exodus 20:24. Judges 6:26
- (ii). Altars of Satan -Ezek. 6:1-4, Acts 17:23; Judges 6:25b.

Each of these classes can further be sub-divided into personal, family, community and national altars.

Examples of positive Altars in the Bible

- (i). Noah Gen. 8:20
- (ii). Abraham Gen. 12:9, Gen. 13:4
- (iii). Isaac Gen. 26:25
- (iv). Jacob Gen. 33:18-20
- (v). Moses Ex. 17:15
- (vi). Gideon Judg. 6:26-27
- (vii). Samuel 1 Sam. 7:17

Example of Negative Altars in the Bible

- (i). Gideon's Father Judges. 6:25-2
- (ii). King Jeroboam 1 King 12:32-33
- (iii). Athenian Acts 17:23.

Altars are Contact Points with Deities

They have supervising spirits that collect sacrifices on behalf of the deity to which have been raised. 1 Cor. 10:19-21; Gen. 28:12

Practical Steps in Dealing with Altars

Make diligent and persistent inquiry about the altars.

(Note that information is basic to effective prayer).

- (i). Begin a process of deep repentance. Feel how God was insulted, slighted and disobeyed by the presence of those altars. Ezra 10:1-2. 12; Neh. 1:4, Acts 19:18-19.
- (ii). Make atonement by the blood of JESUS. Heb.9:13-14.
- (iii). Break all the covenants, pledges, vows, claims sacrifices, dedications made upon those altars.
- (iv). Break all the covenants and blot out all records that relate to the altar. Prayer against the effect of satanic anointing, garments ornaments, images, tokens and sacrifices upon those altars. (Deut. 12:3).
- (v). Use appropriate scripture to pray against the altar.
- (vi). Seek God for certain prophetic scriptures to prophesy upon the altar. (1 Kg. 13, Rev. 5:1-4).

Note that altars also have spiritual ears.

- (vii). Raise a new altars into the Lord in using appropriate scriptures, in place of the one so destroyed and align it to the lamb's altar in heaven. Judges 6:25-26; Rev. 8:3.
- (viii). Proclaim a release over the land, the people and over that have come under the control of such altars.

Conclusion

Negative altars raised by us or our forebears unto Satan constitutes a hindrance to our prayer and walk with God. Like Gideon we need to deal with these altars under Gods direction, so we can be free to fulfil His purposes in our lives.

THE HEAVENS AND THE ELEMENTS

Introduction

The Bible speaks of plural heavens. The highest heaven or the third heaven refers to the dwelling place and throne of God (2 Cor. 12:2). The second heaven, on the other hand, refers to the dwelling place of the spirits Acts 7:42, Eph 6:12, Rev.6:12. The first heaven refers to the starry space that houses the stars, sun, moon and other cosmic bodies. (Gen. 1:14 16; Gen. 15:5 Psalm 103:19).

Between these things God made in the heavens and man, there is an enemy and his host of agents, that seek to use those things to receive satanic worship and in addition, to also oppress man. It is against this backdrop, that the understanding of the heavens and the elements, in relation to spiritual warfare, finds its proper relevance for any well-meaning student of prayer..

God's ordinances for the heavenly bodies

By ordinances is meant the legal rules by which something must operate. These bodies are mandated to be responsible for the following:-

- (i). To give lights on the earth
- (ii). To be for sign and seasons
- (iii). To be for days and years
- (iv). To rule the days and years
- (v). To show God's handwork and declare His glory.

NB: Note that this ordinance of heaven and the elements are supposed to be permanent features (Jer 31:35). (33-19-20).

God prohibits the worship of all heavenly bodies/elements

- Worship of the sun, moon and the hosts of heaven carried the penalty of death. Deut. 17:2-5
- Worship of the sun, moon and stars specifically banned. Deut. 4:19.
- Worship of anything in heaven above prohibited. Ex.20:1-5
- Worshipping the sun was interpreted as denying God. Job. 31:25-27.

Instances where people worshipped the sun, and stars

People have been known to love these elements, serve them, inquire from them, sacrifice to them and dedicate properties and things to them. 2 Kings 17: 16; 21:3-4; 2 Kings 23:11, Jer 19:13; Ezk 8:16; Jer. 8:1-2.

Origin of the worship of the sun

Babel or Babylon was the original place men began to disobey God (Gen. 11:3-9). Sorcery, enchantment, divination, magic, stargazing all started from Babylon. According to Isa. 47:12, Babylon labored in multitudes of sorceries and enchantment since her youth. Satan used this one city to spread and circulate this to many nations through spiritual fornication. (Rev. 17:2).

Man's divine authority over these elements

Beyond the power to subdue the devil and confront sorcerers, God has delegated to the redeemed man, the authority to control all matters, to determine things that must happen and to exercise charismatic dominion over all creation. One way of achieving this through these created bodies in the heavens. Gen 1:28; Ps. 8:2-6

Man's authority and dominion extends to all works of God's hands including the sun, moon stars and the host of heavens. - Ps. 8:6

Legally as joint heirs over all things, the redeemed man's authority. 2 Cor. 5:17-20; Ps.74:16 extends to these elements. 1 Cor. 3:19-22: Rom. 8:17. The blood of Jesus was shed to reconcile all thing including these elements. Col. 1:16-22

Bible examples of dealing with the heavens and elements

- (i). Moses caused darkness in Egypt to deal with the power Egyptians drew from the sun. Ex. 10:21-22
- (ii). Elijah dealt with the elements in the heavens and produced drought for 3 ½ years. 1 Kings 18:41-45
- (iii). Deborah addressed the stars to the advantage of kingdom purposes. - Judges 5:20
- (iv). Isaiah turned the sun dial of Ahaz backward by 10⁰ 2 Kgs. 20; 8-11
- (v). Joshua spoke to the sun and stopped it for one day. Josh. 10:10-12

Some pertinent facts to note

The desert belt of the world are in the zone where the worship of the sun, moon and stars predominates. The least evangelized nations of the world's are in this zone.

Around every throne from where negative authority have been exercised are usually sorcerers, diviners, enchanter, star-gazers and all who draw power from the sun.

Moslems accounting for about one third of the world population pray five times every day pouring enchantments into the bosom of the sun.

Practical hints in praying into the heavens and elements

First understand that God will use His words in our mouth to control the heavens and the elements. (Isa. 51:16).

Ensure the termination of the marriage covenants or contracts between the sorcerers, enchanter, diviners and magicians. (Note that men have been known to do supernatural things on account of the covenants they have with the power in the heavens).

Use the token of the blood of Jesus to wipe out the handwriting of ordinances programmed by wicked men into the heaven and elements

Retrench all satanic priests that minister enchantments into the sun, moon and stars.

Pray and retrieve all properties and things dedicated to the elements.

Instruct the heavens and the elements to give no reply to the programming of satanic agents.

Programme the will and purposes of God into the heavens and command the elements to declare only the glory of God over the land and people (Ps. 19:1-2).

ANOINTING

Introduction

Anointing is the fragrance that is produced from a man's life toward God, when the Holy Spirit is come upon him. It is the manifestation of a man's character, when the Holy Spirit is come upon him. Exodus 30:22 -31.

The Ingredients that make up anointing:

A. Myrrh:

It smells very good but bitter to taste, it speaks of a life that is beautiful, but it is tasted in trials and sufferings. It gives forth a sweet fragrance.

Isa. 53:3-5.

B. Sweet Cinnamon:

The Extract from the bark of a tree, it speaks of the pleasantness of the soul of our Lord Jesus – The lifestyle of a man with anointing.

C. Sweet Calamus:

The stem of certain kinds of plants, such as sugarcane. It speaks of the spirit of a man. The meekness and humility of the man Jesus.

D. Cassia:

It is obtained from the outer back of a tree, it looks and it is broken. It speaks of the outer body of Jesus broken for us.

The Aim of Anointing:

Isa. 10:27. The purpose of anointing is to take away burden from people's life. Isa: 61:1-4.

- (a). Anointing enables us preach the gospel
- (b). To heal the broken hearted
- (c). To proclaim liberty to the captives
- (d). To open prison to those who are bound.
- (e). Anointing produces Gods power.

Three Kinds of Anointing

(a) Priestly Anointing:

This takes us to the Holiest of Holy to minister to God, on behalf of the people and nations. It brings separation. Lev. 16:1 -19; Heb. 5:1-4; 1 Pet. 22

(b) Kingly Anointing:

This helps believers to reign over the devil through the Lord Jesus Christ. It opens the door of authority. Where the word of a King is, there lies his power. Rom. 5:17; Rev. 1: 5-6; Rev. 5:10.

(c) Prophetic Anointing:

The anointing that enables us to see into the plan of God. It makes us by the spirit to overhear conversations that go on in the heavens. You see far ahead of future events

Three Basic Principles of Anointing

- 1) It is from God.
- 2) It is ministered by the Holy Ghost. And the Holy Spirit is a sensitive person.
- 3) We should know how to cultivate the anointing through dedication to the Holy Spirit.

How do we get anointing?

- (a). Seeking the lord- Isa. 40:3. They that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength as the eagle.
- (b). Worship the lord- ps. 92:1-10. But my horn you have exalted like a wild ox. I have been anointed with fresh oil.

Conclusion

Anointing is what makes a difference between a similar message preached by two different people. It is a confirmation of God's presence and or approval upon a man's life and Ministry.

LISTENING TO GOD

Introduction

Listening to God is the purposeful, prayerful and reverential sacred act of consciously tarrying before the Lord with a specific and deep desire of the heart to hear God speak concerning a person, place or an issue. It is also a desire to hear God communicate generally, His mind on an aspect of His regarding the past, present or future of a person or a nation. God spoke in the time of old to all creation. God speaks always and is still speaking today. Moral man must come to God always with an intent to hear and obey.

What Does God Speak?

- *His word which is his mind.*
Ps. 138:28; 33:6, Isa. 55:10-11. Mk. 13:31.
- *His Glory*
Ps. 19:1-6, Ex. 34:5-8, Isa. 42:8.
- *His Ownership of and Sovereignty over His work.*
Dan. 4:28-37, Isa. 44:24
- *His Will for a Generation*
Rom. 9:15-16
- *His Kingdom Plan.*
Gal. 4:4, Eph. 1:3-14

Who hears God speak?

- ❖ The righteous by grace. 2 Cor. 5:17-21
- ❖ The sinner's invitation to repentance. Isa. 1:18
- ❖ The elect concerning their inheritance. Gen. 12:1-5, 15:1-6, Rev. 7:9-12
- ❖ Whosoever hath ears to hear the spirit. Matt. 13:9, Rev. 2:7, 3:22
- ❖ To all nature: Jonah 2:10, Mk. 4:39

When, where and How to listen?

Josh. 1:5, Matt 28:19-20

- * All the time, through man and through nature, events and circumstances - Ps. 29.
- * By divine specification appointment - Jer. 18:1-6, Amos 3:3, Num 9:7-8.)
- * When man resolves to inquire from God on a matter with prayer and fasting - Heb. 2:1, Acts 13:1-2.
- * Anywhere and everywhere - Heb. 1:1.
- * At a God - appointed place - Jer. 17:19-20, Eze. 6:1-2, Jer. 18:1, Num. 11:10-17
- * In the closet hallowed unto God - Hab. 2:1.
- * In the cool and calmness of the heart - Gen. 3:8, Eze: 3:10.
- * In deep horror of darkness of life. - Gen. 15:11-16, 1 Kings 19:9.
- * In the process of obedience - Num. 25:10-13, Matt. 3:13-17, John 10:27.
- * In diligent study of the word - 1 John 4:1-3.
- * In public worship - Ex. 16:9-12, 1 Kings 8:10.

Importance of listening in Intercession

- To walk and pray in the will of God.
- For a timely deliverance - 1 Kings 18:1, 41.
- To fulfil God's purpose for the generation.

Conclusion

Listening to God is an essential attribute all intercessors must acquire for effective, fervent prayers that yield the expected results.

PROPHETIC PRAYING

Introduction

Prophetic prayer is a prayer inspired by the Holy Spirit which affects anything in the Spiritual and physical realm. This prayer comes from the mind of God. A God calls those things that be not as though they were (Romans 4:17). The word of God is raw material in the hand of the Holy Spirit for prophetic praying.

The Role of the Word of God in Prophetic Praying

- (1). It is important to understand that the word of God is the raw material in the hand of God for creation
- (2). Man made in the image of God was given dominion over God's creation and he expresses this dominion through the mouth (Gen. 1:26-28, Ps. 8:2).
- (3). The mouth is the vehicle in the hand of God to express the word of God and his power in prophetic praying (Ps. 8:2-6).
- (4). The word of God can take hold of people, situations or circumstances to establish God's purposes in God's timing. Zech. 4:1-6, Heb. 4:12.

Biblical Example of Prophetic Praying

1. God asked Ezekiel to prophecy to the valley of dry bones, which represents the house of Israel, and it became an exceeding great army - Ezk. 37:1-28.
2. Jeremiah's prophecy against the posterity of Coniah that none of his seed will sit upon the throne of David. Jer. 22:28-29.
3. Ezekiel prophesied to the elders who gave wicked counsel to the people. Ezek. 11:1-13.
4. Jesus prophetic utterance against the fig tree. Mark 11:13-20.
5. David's prophetic utterance against Goliath. 1 Sam. 17:45-47.
6. Elisha prophesied healing to the barren waters and land of Jericho. 2 King 2:18-20
7. Jesus spoke to the decayed body of Lazarus. John 11:43.

Preparation required to the effective prophetic weapon in the hand of the Holy Spirit

1. The spirit and anointing of God must rest upon your life. Isa. 61, Zech. 4, Isa. 45.
 - (a) Open heavens - Ezek: 1:1-
 - (b) Visions of God We must receive the vision of God's purposes for the prophetic praying.
 - (c) The Word of God Came expressly - We need a regular flow of God's word from the spirit man. Rev. 10:8-11, Ezekiel 2:9-3:1-4.
 - (d) The hand of God - We need the hand of God upon our lives, for strength, protection and provision
2. Eat the scroll- there must be enough storage of the word of God inside of you. Josh. 1:8, Ezk.3:1-3, Ps. 1:1-3.
3. Deeper fellowship and communion with God by the Holy spirit. John.15; Job. 22:21
4. Living and walking in the spirit. Rm. 8:1-8; Gal. 5:16- 17; 24-25.
5. Sensitivity to the voice of the Holy Spirit. John 10:4; Ps. 32:8.

Divine Keys to Prophetic Praying

1. Jer. 1:10 God has positioned us above the enemy. He has put all things under our control.
2. Isa. 51:14-16. We have been ordained by God to carry out his purpose.
3. Rev. 5:10. We have been made priests and Kings so that we can reign on the earth. Our Priestly and Kingly authority flows from heaven (the throne of the Lord Jesus Christ) unto us the Church.
4. We need to understand that earth is the Lord's and the fullness thereof. Ps 24:1

Who is qualified to Do Prophetic Praying and Action?

1. The person must be born again, John 3:3-5.
2. The person must live holy and walk in righteousness (Lev. 20:7; 2 Cor. 7:1 Rom. 5:19).;
3. He/She must be led of the Holy Spirit. Rom 8:14.

How to Go About Prophetic praying and Action

- (a). Receive a burden from the Lord
- (b). Receive a direction from the spirit of the Lord
- (c). Check through examples given in the scriptures
- (d). Move as led by the Holy Ghost
- (e). Avoid drawing attention to yourself
- (f). Understand that it is God at work and not you. Isa. 48:11.

Prophetic Actions

Prophetic Actions is a rehearsal of what God is about to do, acting what God is about to do so that it can be recorded in the spirit for a physical manifestation. All of our actions in the physical is recorded or programmed immediately in the spiritual realm. Anything that we do in the physical has a spiritual significance.

Biblical Examples of Prophetic Actions

- * Jesus put clay over the eyes of the blind man Jn. 9
- * Elisha and the healing of the waters of Jericho - 2 Kings 2:19-22.
- * Elisha and the provision for the wife of the son of the prophet -2 Kings 2:19-22.
- * Elisha receives lost axe head -2 Kings 6:1-7
- * Jesus causes, a blind man to see by use of clay- John 9:6
- * Agabus and the future of Paul's Ministry - Acts 21:11
- * Jeremiah's Prophetic Act. Rev. 18:21 Jer. 51:60-

CONCLUSION

In these last days God has brought the revelation of Prophetic Praying to the Church to enhance spiritual warfare. These truths have been hidden over ages but it has pleased the Lord now to make it known to the church for the furtherance of the work of his Kingdom.

THE CELL MINISTRY

Introduction

Very often God does things in response to the prayers of His servants. God honors corporate prayers. "Again I say unto you, that if two of you shall agree on earth as touching anything that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my father which is in heaven" Matt. 18:19. One distinct strategy that the Lord has given for intercession these last days is the coming together of burdened Christians in one accord, as a prayer cell, to make other request known unto God.

It is advisable that those who pray in a particular cell live in the same neighborhood. Members of a prayer cell in a particular neighborhood choose a suitable day in the week when they meet to unburden their heart to God in intercession. The venue for the meeting is the home/residence of one of the praying brethren who would take responsibility as the cell leader. In appointing a cell leader, preference should be given to burdened and committed married couples as cell leaders who are ready to offer their homes as a holy altar for intercession. Homes of unmarried brethren may be considered as a prayer cell venue in the absence of a suitable home of committed married couples.

Those praying in a particular cell observe a fast between 6.a.m and 6 p.m., on the prayer cell day. In the course of the day, they remain conscious of their obligation to the Lord by reading the Scriptures and praying as often as they find time. This is applicable to those cell members who may not have a work free day on their chosen cell prayer day. When the fast is broken by 6p m cell members are advised to rest and possibly sleep. About 11.30 p.m. They report at the prayer cell venue where they are led in intercession and spiritual warfare from mid night to 3 a.m.

The house of prayer in a particular town or state must have developed a prayer bulletin to guide the prayers.

Consider the following scriptures

- God is asking for intercessors or mediators- Isa. 54:16, Ezek 22:30
- God teaches spiritual warfare - Psalm 144:1

- Weapons of spiritual warfare - Ephesians 6:12-
- We are to uproot and plant - Jer. 1:8-10-
- God honors corporate prayers-Matt. 18:19.
- Example of Corporate prayer and its effect Acts. 12:5-17
- God blesses homes dedicated for his work Hab. 2:20; II Chron. 29:5.

Conclusion

Effective Intercessions from cells help in preparing the ground for the expected revival. It is much easier to deliver the land (Community or city) where there is effective cell praying than where there is none. Cell praying changes the Spiritual atmosphere of the city when it is done.

Throughout church history, revivals are preceded by intercessions of Christians. When burdened Christians fast and pray unto God, at this time the devil is most active, the Lord responds the devil is defeated. Destinies of nations and peoples are changed in response to fasting and prayers of men who lift up Holy hands unto the Lord.

INTERCESSION AND HOLINESS

Introduction

Intercession is the holy, believing, persevering prayer that pleads with God on behalf of a person, people or place which desperately needs God's intervention. It is viewed from the point of being a MEDIATOR. (Isaiah 53:12; Romans 8:26-34)

Holiness is an attribute of one's heart that makes him/her conform to the image of God.

- (a). It is a call to all. (1 Pet. 1:14- 16; 2 Pet. 3:11; Matt. 5:20, Heb. 12:14)
 - (b). It is a call to accept and appropriate through faith separation, cleansing and dedication to God and His service. Heb. 9:13-14; John 5:24, 40; 10:10; Rev. 21:8; John 3:16; 1 Tim. 5:22; Titus 2:11 -12.
- Holiness is an integral part of a successful intercession

The Scope of Intercession

The prayer of intercession can lead one to cover wide areas such as:

- Sinners (Isaiah 53:12; Ps. 22:27).
- Weak Christians (Luke 22:32)
- The Church -Ps. 149:6-9
- The Land - Gen. 3:17; Lev. 18:25
- Enemies (Luke 23:34)
- The Afflicted (2 Ch. 7:14; 1 Tim. 2:1-4).

Qualities (Ingredients) of Intercession

- Burden and vision (Neh. 1:1-3; 2:1-3; Dan. 9)
- Obedience to God - Deut. 28:1-15.
- Holy Life Isaiah 52: 11b; Lev. 19:2
- Humility -James 4:7-10; 1 Peter 5:6
- Consistency with time - Dan. 6; 1 Chron. 12:32.
- Developing your communion with God - Job. 22:21.

The Precept and the place of Holiness in Intercession

1. The Precept: It is the command of the Lord to His people Lev. 11:14-45; Ex. 19:6; Luke 1:67-79; 2 Cor. 7:1; Rom. 12:1; Eph. 1:4; Heb. 12:14; 1 Pet. 1:16; 2 Pet. 3:11; Matt. 5:20, 40.
2. The Place of Holiness: God is holy (Lev. 11:44; 1 Peter 1:15) and His home is holy (Psalm 15:1; 24:3). Ex. 15:11; 1 Sam. 2:2; Ps. 22:3; 99:9; 145:7, Isaiah 6:2-3; 49:7; 57:15; Lev. 11:44; Mal. 3:6.

Prevailing in Holiness

- (a). Study diligently and apply the word of God in all the circumstances of your life. Ps. 119:9-11;
- (b). John 15:1-4; 17:16-17; Matt. 4:4.
- (c). Pray constantly the prevailing prayer of faith. Luke 22:46; 18:1; 1 Thess. 5:17; James 5:17.
- (d). Avoid all occasions of sin. (1 Thess. 12:11; James 4:7; Col. 3:1-6;).
- (e). Identify with Christ in all things (Rev. 12:11; Col. 3:17; Matt. 10:32-33).
- (f). Examples of people that interceded with an exemplary Holy life.

Abraham	-	Gen. 18:17-33
Moses	-	Ex. 32:1-33
Esther	-	Esther 4:1-16
Nehemiah	-	Neh. 1:1-11
Daniel	-	Dan. 9:1-20
Jesus Christ	-	John 17
Paul	-	Eph. 1:16-23; Col. 1:9-12.

Conclusion

An intercessor is a mediator between God and man or any objection of intercession, since the nature of the Christian. God is Holiness, the intercessor cannot make much progress unless he takes on the nature of Holiness. Is. 59:1-2.

INTERCESSION AND THE HOLY SPIRIT

Introduction

The intercessor is one who stands in the gap between God on one hand and people or event on the other. The Intercessor through the help of the Holy Spirit and the scriptures understands the mind of God. His intercession and warfare is to plead with God to bring to pass that which is in the mind of God. He could also plead with God to arrest a deserved punishment as Moses did on behalf of the children of Israel.

Teaching

- The Intercessor is one who is truly born of water and of the Spirit- John 3:5, 16
- He is totally separated spiritually from personal involvement in the occult as well as practices of their fore bears. -Judges 6:25, John. 14:30
- The Intercessor lives holy in Christ Jesus -1 Pet 1:16
- He is continually filled with the Holy Spirit - Eph.5:18-19; Acts. 4:31.
- He is baptized of the Holy Spirit-Acts 1:8, Acts 2:38-39
- He is led of the Holy Spirit continually-Roman 8:14
- The Intercessor enjoys deep and continuous intimacy with Jesus as enabled by the Holy Spirit. - Eph. 2:22.
- Revelation by the Holy Spirit aids the Intercessors prayer: - Luke 2:26
- The Intercession is not mechanical nor does he follow a set of formulae in his intercessory work, but prays as led of the Holy Spirit. Rom. 8:26; Isa. 11:2-4.
- Holy Ghost gives direction Acts 16:6. Acts 13:14, 2 Peter 1:21
- When Intercession is done as led by the Holy Spirit, God is bound to answer. 1Jn. 5:14.
- Example- The life of Simeon -Luke 2:25-27
- Practical Biblical Example - Lk. 2:25 B27
 - (i). The Holy Spirit was upon Simeon Vs-25
 - (ii). The Holy Spirit revealed to Him that he would not die until he had seen Jesus. Vs 26.
 - (iii). The Holy Spirit moved him into the temple Vs. 27.

Conclusion

We cannot make much progress in intercession if we do not advance in our dependence on the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit knows the mind of God and is in total agreement with the Scriptures. He is our true help in intercession. Dependence on the Holy Spirit leads us into the area of prophetic intercession.

INTERCESSION AND REVELATION

Introduction

Intercession is seeking the presence of God and hearing Him on behalf of others while revelation is the uncovering or knowing what God says either through the written or spoken word and visions about nations, individuals and situations are part of God's redemptive plan for his people. Intercession and revelation were used from the foundation of the nation of Israel, during her deliverance and restoration. The establishment of the nation in righteousness in all aspect of life was through intercession and revelation, when God's plan for his people seems to fail as a result of sin, there is need for repentance, intercession and fasting to obtain fulfilment and restoration. The ministries of Moses, Daniel and Jesus Christ are good examples. All that the law (Moses) and the prophets (Elijah) Spoke concerning Christ were confirmed through sustained life of intercession and the early church experienced great success through intercession and revelation.

1. Foundation

Interceding for the revelation of the law (God's word):

This helped Israel to lay the foundation of her nation on sound principles of God's word (religiously, socially and economically).

God's Word (Revelation)

- (a). Moses received God's word through forty night's intercession and fasting Deut. 9:9-14, 25-29; 10:11.
- (b). By intercession, Moses received the pattern for the Tabernacle, how to raise the building material, fund and workers. Ex. 24-32; 35-40.
- (c). God's word was needed in dealing with crisis that threatened God's covenant and people. Exodus chapters 32-33.
- (d). At the tent. Moses negotiated through intercession for Israel's restoration and the reviewing of the covenant, Exodus 33:7-34:3.
- (e). Constructing God's house according to pattern, was done through intercession revelation Exodus Chapter 35-40.
- (f). We must intercede for God's revelation for the restoration of our nation and church.

Interceding For the Prophetic Revelation

Through intercession and revelation we can know from God the truth of Kingdoms /powers that govern us. Dan. 2:31,-35.

We need to know the strength and weakens of their power to enable us deal adequately with them.

Living Animals and Birds Combined

This is a mixture or combination of power.

- | | |
|------------|----------------------------|
| (1). Lion | (4). Leopard |
| (2). Eagle | (5). Mysterious -beast Ram |
| (3). Bear | (6). He goat etc. |

There are creatures that rulers and nations have as their symbols of strength and worship. All national and individuals secrets and their problems are known to God. As we intercede, God reveals these secrets to us to deal with the power of darkness that govern our nation through these rulers.

2. Revelation:

In the place of intercession revelation is received concerning God's programme for the restoration of Israel Dan. 9:1-27; Isa. 58:12; Jer. 30:17-21; Ezek. 36: 26-38.

(a) The Time for Restoration

(b) The people for Restoration. Spiritual Restoration:

- (1). Finish transgression
- (2). Make an end of sins
- (3). Make reconciliation for iniquity
- (4). Bring everlasting righteousness
- (5). Seal up the vision and prophecy
- (6). Anoint the most holy. Dan. 9:24.

The restoration of a nation and her people starts with the new birth of the heart. You must be born again.

(c) The Holy City -Jerusalem and nation of Israel:

- (1). Building Jerusalem (your city)

- (2). Building the streets again
- (3). Building the walls again
- (4). Building the temple again
- (5). Worship restored
- (6). The incarnation of the Messiah. Dan. 9:25-26.

All that have truth explained.*

Through sustained intercession, revelations and insight by Daniel, Israel was restored and prepared for future ministry. This kind of intercession will help us to receive, understand and apply God's revelation in our situations and nations.

Interceding for the Confirmation of the sacred scriptures.

- (a) The Resurrection of the planted word -Moses:
 - Moses speaks of the law which God through him gave to His people. Lk. 9:30-31; 24:26-27, 44.
- (b) The Rain of the Word from Heaven –Elijah
 - Elijah speaks of the word which God through the prophets gave his people, Luke 9:30-31; 24:25-27.
 - The law and the prophet witness Christ, his death and resurrection.
 - Through all night intercession Jesus was transformed, the written word became a living word and spoke to Him, his Kingship was confirmed to the three apostles and they heard and saw his Glory.
 - We can through intercession receive a confirmation of all God's promises in Christ Jesus to us. Matt. 17:1-9; Mark 9:1-9 Lk. 9:28-36; II Pet. 1:16-21.

Interceding For the Confirmation of the Church's Inheritance in the Spirit:

- (1). The promise of the Holy Spirit (Acts 1:12-24;1-4). To receive the Holy Spirit, fellowship with him and maintain His work through us, we must intercede, following the example of the early church.
- (2). The Heavenly position of the church (Eph. 1:16-23; 2:1-10). Intercession for the church will bring the desired insight, wisdom and

faith for the church to tap the inexhaustible power of God to deal with every power of darkness.

(3). The inward strength in the Spirit. Eph. 3:14-21.

- One of the major ways to deal with personal spiritual weakness is through intercession.
- It brings us at par with the saints of old in the spirit to comprehend the breadth, length, depth and height of God's revelation, love and fullness.

Conclusion

Through sustained intercession, every generation gains insights in God's word to deal with national issues, matters affecting the church and personal problems.

THE EFFECTIVE INTERCESSOR

Introduction.

The intercessor is one who goes to God to plead on behalf of others. And I sought for a man among them that should make up the hedge and stand in the gap before me for the land, that I should not destroy it: but I found none. Ezek 22:30. The effective intercessor is a true friend of God. He is respected and recognized by God (Exodus 33:11, Jer. 15:1). There is a difference between being an effective intercessor and one who is active in intercessory activities. Below are the qualifications and qualities of the effective intercessor.

The Effective Intercessor

- The effective intercessor is a born again Christian John 3:3,5; John 1:12
- He lives holy in Christ Jesus -Lev. 11:44; 1 Pet 1:16
- He is a good student of the Holy Scriptures - Ps. 119:11-2 Tim 2:15
- He is a disciplined Christian -1 Cor. 9:27
- He is totally yielded to Christ and is separated from personal or ancestral occultic influences Phil. 1:21, Judges 6:25
- He is a Christian with a burden(s) in his heart -Rom 9:1-3
- He allows himself to be led of the Holy Spirit continually-Romans 8:14
- He knows what it means to wait on God in prayer
- He listens to God continually-John 10:27
- He remains alert in the Spirit-1 Cor 2:9-10; Ps. 32:8
- He is prepared to pay the price of intercession- Esther 4:6
- He gives glory to God for the results of intercession- Luke 17:10
- He is humble 1 Pet.5:6.
- He believes God's report - John 12:38
- He is bold Daniel 3:17-18

Examples in Moses, Daniel and 3 friends, Esther and Paul.

Exodus 32:7-14; Dan. 9:1-19; Esther 5; Gal. 4:19.

Conclusion

God is moved by the quality of our intercession not by the quantity. Quality intercession flows from a consecrated, Bible filled and spirit led life. The effective intercessor brings forth quality intercession.

THE INTERCESSOR AS AN ALL ROUND CHRISTIAN

Introduction

Effective intercession in our circumstance must necessarily involve spiritual warfare. And spiritual warfare is a power game between the kingdom of God and that of Satan. The common temptation for many Christians is that as we advance in exercising the power gifts in spiritual warfare, we tend to neglect those aspects of the faith that deal with the fruit of the spirit. We need a balance in our Christian growth and experience. As we grow in the exercise of spiritual gifts we must also grow in the demonstration of the fruit of the spirit in our daily living

Intercessor as an all-round Christian

- Spiritual warfare is power encounter between the kingdom of God and that of Satan-Matt 18:18,
- Nature of Spiritual warfare and the main ingredients are exemplified in the lives of Esther and Daniel, Esther 2-8, Daniel 1-6
- Spiritual gift is exercised in spiritual warfare-1 Cor. 12:3
- Discernment of Spirit is important in spiritual warfare 1 Cor 12:10
- The fruit of the Spirit is a must for all intercessors Gal 5:22-26

The intercessor needs to be an all-round Christian in all aspects of the faith. So he could be free of Satan's accusation and his praying would not be hindered, Rev. 12:10, Isa. 59:1-3, John 14:30

- Give practical examples, where available of Christians who major in the exercise of spiritual gifts (warfare) to the neglect of the demonstration of the fruit of the spirit. Make reference to the end or result of their Ministry.
- God expects that the intercessor be blameless see examples- the life of Paul and Moses Phil. 3:15, 2 Cor. 7:2; Acts. 24:16; 1 Tim. 6:6-11; Col. 3:17-23; Philip. 4:8. Numbers 12:3

Conclusion

As the Lord gives us help in the area of intercession and Spiritual warfare we must not neglect the aspect of a true Christian character- fruit of the Spirit. If

we do so we shall appear sound before other Christians and the World. Remember that Apostle Paul the great Intercessor was an all-round Christian. Note also that in the final analysis, we shall be judged not by how much power we exercised but by the quality of the lives we lived on earth.

THE INTERCESSOR AND MONEY

Introduction

While the Intercessor might have taken care of the very obvious traps of the enemy such as breaking of covenants and ties, he may be caught in the subtle bondage of the adversary in the area of business and money. How we make money and how we use money is the clearest outside indicator of what we really believe. As no servant can serve two masters; for either he will hate the one and love the other or else he will hold to one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon. Luke 16:13.

Areas of Business Bondage

- (a). Pride: An air of Financial Superiority and air of A Christian Celebrity will manifest in pride -Phil. 2:3, James 2:9. On the other hand an air of lack and frustration will cause grumbling and ungratefulness to God -1 Tim. 6:6
- (b). Inordinate: Pursuit of Success (Over work): Many pay more attention to working out their success than trusting in God and doing the will of God even in business-Psalm 127:2.
- (c). Indebtedness: Proverbs 22:7; Proverbs 27:12.
- (d). Laziness/Disorganization/Negligence: This does not justify overworking to the detriment of everything else rather it highlights a biblical principle that Laziness is sin Proverbs 6:6-9, Romans 12:11.
- (e). A Get-Rich Quick Mentality: Proverbs 28:20 Get-Rich Quick Mentality leads to three basic errors namely:-
 - 1. Getting involved with things you can understand
 - 2. Risking funds you cannot afford to lose borrowed funds
 - 3. Making hasty decisions you have not thoroughly prayed about.

Knowing the importance of money in our Christian and secular walk, one needs to do realistic planning both in business and personal life.

Basic Biblical Standards in Business:

- (a). Reflect Christ in your business practice- by their fruits ye shall know them -1 Cor. 4:1.
- (b). Be accountable: - God is interested in our profit; a part of it is Him. Without system of checks and balances anyone will eventually drift off course.
- (c). Provide a quality product at a fair price. Let there be excellence in your products and services.
- (d). Honor your Creditors:
 - Lev. 19:13 - Mal. 3:5
 - Proverbs 3.27-28

Vision for the Intercessor in Business

- (a). Funding the Gospel - Proverbs 3:9
- (b). Meeting the needs of those who depend on you e.g. your employees - James 5:4, your Family -1 Tim. 5:8.
- (c). Discipleship 1 Tim. 2:2, James 1:22.
- (d). Making Profit: no business can succeed without making profit but profit must not be made at the exclusion of other elements of a biblically based business. Profit sharing should include the employees.

Priorities in the Use of Money

- (a). Pay your Suppliers:** Proverbs 12:22, Proverbs 3:27. Many Christians are in debts of various forms. When someone orders materials with an implied promise to pay but does not do so, that person is simply lying.
- (b). Pay your employees** there is a tendency for the owner of the business to want to withdraw his allowance before thinking of the employees but that is not biblically correct Phil. 2:3.
- (c). Pay Owner's Needs:** This is not the common practice but this should be the pattern for those who are absolutely committed to follow Christ.
- (d). Business Ethics**
 - (i). Misuse of company property or office:**
 - Abuse or telephone usage
 - Misuse of company vehicles

- Proverbs 4:14.

(ii). Fraud:

- Total honesty is the minimum expected from an Intercessor -
Proverbs 10:9

(iii). Taxes:

- To cheat on income taxes or any other tax due is a sin and sin separates us from God.

The Integrity of the Intercessor

Proverbs 11: What is your Word Worth?

ESTHER THE INTERCESSOR

Text: The Book of Esther

Introduction

Many people do not know why they are placed where they are and God's purposes for and through them. Esther presents this picture.

The Odds against Esther:

- She was an orphan
- She was operating in a foreign land (a captive)
- The nation wherein she sojourned was made of a wicked, very temperamental people with extreme emotions. Esther 1:10-22; Notice the case with which they make decrees which must not be altered.

Esther before Intercession -Esther 2:7-20

- Was humble and totally obedient to her uncle.
- She was a virgin (kept her purity until she was properly married).
- She was caring to her uncle and was concerned about his welfare.
- She was ignorant of the goings-on in the palace. Esther. 4:1-13.
- She was a contented woman.

Esther the Intercessor. Esther 4:13

- She was properly schooled by her uncle Mordecai who was diligent enough to follow the state of affairs.

Mordecai-patient with her until she caught the vision.

- She accepted her rebuke and made corrections she accepted Godly counsel. Esther 4:13.
- Accepted the challenges of intercession without
- She adopted both corporate and individual approach to intercession. Esther 4:16A
- As an Intercessor even though she was comfortable yet she could fast for her Nation, and called others to fast Esther 4:165
- Took risk (trusting God) to stand before the King.

- She was not in a hurry but very tactful and her intercession was focused and directed. Esther 7:3, 4.
- Esther used her strategic position of authority to enhance the work of intercession. Esther 4:14
- Was not satisfied with short term result so she through intercession she secured both her life and the life of the nation, Israel.
- Esther realized why she was made a queen in a foreign land (Gen. 45:5-6) through intercession.
- She did not allow her disadvantages to prevent her from intercession.

The Burden for Esther's Intercession (1 Sam. 17:29)

- For Esther the cause was serious Esther 3:6-15. Relate this to John 10:10
- She Interceded out of a deep burden.
- There cannot be proper Intercession without a burden. She interceded out of a deep burden.

Results of Esther's intercession

- (a). The destiny of the Jews was changed as a result of her intercession. Esther 8:15-17.
- (b). As a result of her intercession God reversed the wicked plans of their enemies. (Esther 7:9-10)
- (c). Her intercessions was able to move the king to fulfil God's purposes for the Jewish Nation Esther 8:7-11.
- (d). Our Intercession can move ungodly men to do what they normally would not do. Esther 6:1-3.
- (e). Her intercession brought National revival Esther 8:17b.
- (f). Her Intercession restored power to the Jew (the church). -

Conclusion

Esther came in as in-experience and ignorant young woman. But she submitted herself to be taught (by Mordecai). When her eyes were opened, she never looked back. Go and do likewise.

THE WHOLE ARMOUR OF GOD

Introduction

The reason why Christians are advised to put on the whole armour of God is to withstand the wiles of the devil. The enemy we are dealing with, has strategies, devices and tactics. If we do not put on the whole armor we cannot withstand him in the evil day.

- Samson did everything but could not stand the strange flesh of a woman Judges 16:19.
- Judas walked with the other disciples but could not withstand the love of money and covetousness. Matt 26:14-16

1. Defense armor- (Eph. 6:13-18)

Gird your waist with: there is a belt to hold your character together. Truth gives balance to a man's character that you don't fall. Truth speaks of the word of God. The devil looks for a particular weakness in us, if it is not dealt with he will wait for us and use it for destruction notably:

David - Lust,

Gehazi- Covetousness,

Moses- Anger, etc.

2. Breast Plate of righteousness

Breast plate has to do with the heart. The heart is a delicate place, when a bullet touches the heart, the result is instant death. With the heart man believeth unto righteousness. Heart is the strongest place in man. Keep heart with all diligence, for cut of it are the issues of life. Prov. 4:23.

Breastplate of love faith. 1 Thess 5:8

- (a). Joseph -Righteousness-love- faith kept him waiting 13 years.
- (b). Daniel righteousness - sustained him in lion's den - faith 21 days prayer.

3. Shod your feet with preparation of the gospel of peace

One of the most important aspect of the soldier's body is his feet. Take proper care of the feet, make sure that the gospel is preached always.

Evangelism- witnessing at all times. When it is strong - it can break doors easily, it makes preaching easy for you.

4. The shield of faith

Not faith to confess and receive, but faith to move God's plan forward. Faith for spiritual warfare.

(1) Abraham- seed (2) Joshua -wall of Jericho

(3) Mary-pregnancy.

5. Helmet of Salvation

This armor has to do with the brain, your head. Very delicate. All that Jesus obtained for us at the cross.

If the enemy gets you in sickness, poverty you are in trouble. Gal. 3:13-14; Isa. 53:2 B 19

II. Offensive armor

The Sword of the Spirit

1. The only offensive weapon in the. Isa. 55:10. The word of God is dew and of God is like hammer-fire- I have exalted my word above my name Ps. 138:2. God watching over His word to perform it. Jer. 1:12. Word of God sharper than any two edged sword Heb. 4:16. The bridge between the visible and the invisible is the word God. Heb. 11:3.
2. Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the spirit, being watchful to this end with all perseverance and supplication for all the saints.

Conclusion

This is the picture of the church prepared for battle against the unseen forces of darkness. As we gird ourselves with these whole armor by God's grace, we will not fall in the evil day.

SPIRITUAL MAPPING

Introduction

Spiritual Mapping is an exercise that leads to obtaining spiritually discerned information about a community, city or country. Such information, which could be placed on a map, becomes an excellent tool for Spiritual Warfare.

Type of Information needed on the Map

- Satanic altars
- Witches and wizards covens
- Strong man, evil and wicked men
- Criminal hideout
- Abortion centers
- Evil forest and lands
- Places where human parts are sold.
- Ancient slave spots/markets
- Ancient gates and entrances into the city
- School and markets
- Places where hard drugs are sold.
- The ways and the type of activities that goes on there.
- Police stations
- Hotels and Brothels
- Occultic centers
- False churches
- White garment churches
- Hospital
- Sacred trees

How to Source Information

(a)Through Research and Data

- (i). Research -Investigations
- (ii). Fasting and seeking Gods face.

Process:

- i. The use of questionnaire

- ii. The use of traditional rulers or elders of the town/community
- iii. The use of history books
- iv. Visits to survey offices
- v. Newspapers and Personal observation and interviews.

(b) Data: What Data is:-

This is a compilation of proven and tested information got through research. Information from, the "Data Bank" can now be used for the mapping.

Why We Must Search.

- (a). Intercessory burden is enhanced by what we see. - Neh. 2:11:17.
- (b). Searching enables us to discern and identify the exact spots where evil is in operation.
- (c). Enable the intercessor to size up the problem for a corresponding attack.
- (d). Facilitates effective use of human and material resources in spiritual and strategic warfare.
- (e). It makes room for proper zoning of the area for effective prophetic actions.

Areas of Research

1. The heavens - Ps. 19:1-6.

- (a). The heavens are part of the earth separated Gen. 1:6-8.
- (b). The heavens are not just an empty space, without activities going on there. Most of these activities influence the lives and events on earth - Eph. 6:12.
- (c). Every altar on earth has a corresponding throne in the heavens. Jer. 44:15-19; Isa. 47; Ps. 19; 1-6.

2. The Land

Man's life is greatly influenced by the land. He lives, plants and drinks from the land.

3. The Waters

Job 40, Ezk. 29; Rev. 17:15-18. The knowledge of the activities of these spirits and their influences around keeps us on the alert.

Discerning Spiritual Stronghold

Most strong holds are not visible in the physical. These will be need for:

Seeing the land- Num. 13:18

Whether it be good or bad Vs. 19

Whether it be fat - Vs.20. These can only be done with perfect spiritual sight and insight.

The Character of the Land

The Character of the land in any place is seen in the lives of the people that live in the place

Wicked lands have wicked acts-e.g. Sodom, Gen. 18:20, e.g. Amorites and Vs. 15:16.

But when a lands is sown with Godly altars, peace and righteousness is also manifested. Gen. 12:

Evil land and forest were not created evil, but were made evil because of the evil altars on them.

Nature of the map

The map could be on a piece of paper, clay or cardboard sheets Ezkel 4:1-2

The information on the Map

The information should be properly displayed and simple enough so that anybody can use and interpret it. The roads, trees, churches and alters should be represented in the legends.

The spiritual meaning of the map

Just as the map of a nation or flag of a nation represents that nation. The currency of a nation could be used to represent the economy of that nation, so does the mapping have a lot of spiritual significance, for Spiritual Warfare.

Conclusion

1. Spiritual Mapping is needed for spiritual warfare for the following reason:-
2. To be able to seize up the enemies fortifications for a corresponding attack.
3. It makes for proper management for personnel Ex. 17:8-13
4. Proper management of resources and materials Neh. 47:15
5. Effective use of the night type of weapons.
6. It helps the commander to seek for effective strategy for the attack.
7. With the targets located, it gives a good sense of direction, for prophetic praying, and actions
8. A well-made map makes the jobs easier.
9. Very useful and in prophetic praying Ezkel 37:15-22.

Prophetic demonstration actions. And laying spiritual siege can be done through the map Gen. 13:17 Ezkel 4:2, Ezkel 21:22, Jos 6:1-3, Ezkel 5. We can set our faces on the cites through the map.

SPIRITUAL WARFARE

Introduction

What is Spiritual Warfare?

Ex. 15:3. Gen. 1:26-28 Grand, completely fashioned an everlasting designed act of combat by God for his Children to be trained in the act of Governance, it is entirely spiritual, and fought inside of us. It is equally a battle fought through us, and a battle fought continually.

Why do we fight? Judges 3:1-4

1. In order to be trained in the act of enforcing God's Lordship over all creation
2. Ps. 24:1-2 (That His will may be done on earth as is in heaven Luke 11:2-4)
3. To show our obedience to God and our Lord Jesus Christ. Luke 11:2, Heb. 11:32-34.
4. To execute judgment written by God against the enemy of God and man. Gen. 3:14-15, Ps. 149:7-9, Luke 10:18-19, Coll. 2:14-15.
5. To set the captives of the devil free Isa. 61:1-3, Isa. 49:24-26, Luke 4:18-21.
6. To recover all that the enemy has stolen. Gen. 14:15, Mal. 3:10-12, Joel 2:25.
7. To destroy satanic covering over people, nation, churches etc. Isa. 25:7
8. To enforce the reconciliation of all things unto God - Col. 1:12-22, 2 Cor. 5:18-20.

Examples of Spiritual Warfare.

The fall of Lucifer. Isa 14:12-23, Ezkel 23:12-19. Luke 10:18. Rev. 12:7-11

Moses and Pharaoh- Ex. 5-7

Joshua in the battle of Gibeon-Josh 10-26

Deborah and Barak against Sisera and Jabin Judges 4:5.

Gideon and the Medianites - Judges 6-7.

David and Goliath 1 Sam. 17.

Elijah and the prophets of Baal - 1 King 18:21-40,

King Herod and the Church - Acts. 12:1-24.

Paul in Ephesus - Acts. 19:23-30.

Results of Spiritual Warfare

1. Hidden powers in believers are released. Mi.16:15-20
2. Captives are set free - Is. 49:24-26.
3. All manner of yokes are destroyed - Ex. 15:21
4. The kingdom of God is established. Dan, 4:34: 6:26
5. God the Father, Son and the Holy Spirit is glorified 1 King 18:39.
6. The Church grows and is strengthened - Acts 4:23-31.
7. The word of God grows and is multiplied - Acts 12:24
8. Powers of darkness are bound, destroyed and exposed - Acts 16: 16-18;
1 Kings 18:40
9. Hierarchy of Powers in Warfare Eph. 6:12; Ps. 2:1-12; Ps. 110:1-7.

Hierarchy of powers in warfare

Eph 6:12; Ps 2:1-12; Ps 110:1-7

1. Satanic Powers

- | | |
|---|---|
| (a). Principalities | (d). Spiritual wickedness in high places. |
| (b). Powers | |
| (c). Rulers of the darkness of this world | (e). Territorial spirits |
| | (f). Elemental spirits |

2. God's Army

- (a). The Hosts of heaven (Angels)
- (b). The Saints (Christian Church)

Qualities of the Lord's Army

Ps. 24:3-4, 2 Cor. 6:12-18; 1 Cor. 3:11-17; 2 Tim. 2:19-25: Josh 1:8; Isa. 50:4-5.

- (a). Have clean hands and pure heart

- (b). Meditate on the word of God day and night.
- (c). Observe to do the will of God:
- (d). Be ready to learn, to receive and hear the word of God.
- (e). Must be ready to wait on the Lord. - Isa. 40:31; Daniel 9:3
- (f). Must be pure/righteous.
- (g). Must be faithful.
- (h). No hypocrisy/Deceit - Jer. 48:10: Acts. 19:14.
- (i). Ready to pray until... - Isa. 62:6-7
- (j). Depend on the Holy Ghost.

Hindrances

Psalm 66:18, Hosea 4:6

- (a). Sin
- (b). Lack of Knowledge
- (c). Foundations – roots, marriages
- (d). Fear
- (e). Spiritual blindness, deafness and lack of communication with the Holy Ghost
- (f). Double - mindedness.

Areas of Spiritual Warfare

1. Family (Home)/Personal;
2. Community/Territorial Land
3. Institutions
4. Trade
5. The Church
6. Deliverance for the afflicted.

Weapons of our spiritual warfare

The Voice of the Lord - Ps. 29.

The Word of God - Eph. 6:17

The blood of Jesus - Rev. 12:11

The word of our testimony - Rev. 12:11

Weapons of the enemy

(i). Dedication
(iii). Accusation - Rev. 12:10

(ii). Fiery darts - Eph. 6:16

Conclusion

Events in the physical are determined by what happens in the spiritual realm.
Through spiritual Warfare control of the spiritual realm is determined.
Spiritual warfare is unavoidable for any genuine Christian.

WEAPONS OF SPIRITUAL WARFARE

Introduction

Believers are in spiritual conflict against the unseen forces of the devil. There are spiritual weapons provided in the scripture to fight this battle. These can only be effective when they are channeled through God. (1 Cor. 10:3-5). God equally has a lot of weapons in his heavenly armory (Jer. 50:25). God spiritually positions his people to use these weapons. (Jer. 1:10, Eph. 1:3; Eph. 2:1-6).

Different Spiritual Weapons in God's Heavenly Armory

1. **The Word of God as a Weapon:** Zech. 1:5-6. Judgment of Jerusalem- The word of God in Jeremiah's mouth took hold of - Kings- Princes temple - people and delivered them to the Chaldeans. The word of God has the ability to take hold on strongmen and deal with them, when spoken under anointing.

2. **Prophecy as a Weapon**

Isa. 8:9-10 - Dealing with evil Associations and conspiracies

Isa. 7:5-7 - Dealing with governmental heads

Isa 14:24-27 - Dealing on the purpose of God.

Isa. 49:24-25 - Prophecy on deliverance of Captives

{Isa. 44:24-28

Job 5:12-16} - Prophecy against occultic tokens and devices

Jer. 10:11. 15- Judgment on false gods/demons

Isa. 47:1-15 - Judgment on occultists/water spirit

Jer. 51:11-14 - Judgment against Babylon

1 Kings 13 1-2: Dealing with altars

3. **East Wind**

The east wind was used to deal with Pharaoh and Egypt. It opened the Red - Sea. Brought the covering of darkness - heaviness can be lifted-dealing with satanic princes.

References to the East Wind:

- | | |
|-------------|--|
| Ex. 14:21 | - Opens up the way for the people of God. |
| Ps. 48:7; | - Ez. 27.26 Breaks enemy's worship |
| Ps. 78:26 | - Gives rise to the East wind of the Lord |
| Isa. 27.8 | - God's instrument of contention |
| Jer. 18:17 | - Scatters God's enemies and brings calamity |
| Ezek. 19:12 | - Dries up, breaks down and withers. |
| Hosea 13:15 | |
| Jonah 4:8 | |

4. Weapon of Praise: Ps. 47:1-3

The walls of Jericho fell down when they shouted - the battle between Jehoshaphat and Moabites. God's address is praise

- * God inhabits the praise of his people
- * God breathes in praise and breathes out blessings
- * If you want to pray long - worship long.

Instances of the use of Praise as weapon of war include:

The fall of the wall of Jericho (Josh. 6:20)

The battle between Jehoshaphat and the Moabites (2 Chr. 20.22-23)

Paul and Silas Acts 16:25-26).

5. The Name Jesus: Phil, 2:9-11.

When the name of Jesus Christ is mentioned, it involves his personality-power-purpose. Ps. 20; 7-8.

6. The Blood of Jesus Rev. 12:11; Rev. 5:9-10.

Super powerful in deliverance- being powerful, deliverance breaks when you apply the blood of Jesus.

7. Natural Weapons that could be applied in spiritual battles.

Hail stones-thundering of God - the earthquake of God-voices of God Ps. 29:1 -11; Lightenings - Ps. 18:6-15; Job 38:22-25.

8. The Arm of the Lord

This weapon speaks of the spirit of the Lord – and what it does, in times of battle- God's vengeance against his foes - Isa 51:9; 52:10.

Conclusion

The Prayer student must realize that a thorough knowledge of the weapons at his disposal is a prerequisite for effectiveness. He must come to appreciate that besides the blood and the name of Jesus, God has an inexhaustible store house of weapons. It must, however, be noted that the effectiveness of these weapons is a function of the consecration and lifestyle of the intercessor or prayer student.

THE SPIRIT OF JEZEBEL

Bible Reading: Ps. 59:1-17, 2 King 9:22

Introduction.

Who is Jezebel?

She was the daughter of of Ethbaal the king of Zidon dedicated to Baal and the wife of Ahab and Israel to whoredom. (1 Kings 16:33) The Spirit of Jezebel is the spirit of witchcraft manipulation and control. Witchcraft is the operation, manipulation and control using any spirit different from the Holy Spirit.

- * A witch is a person who uses magic for evil purposes or practises sorcery.
- * A sorcerer is one that practices magic with the help of evil spirit.
- * Witches excel in wickedness. Occultic practice is enhanced by the practice of witchcraft.

Characteristics of the Spirit of Jezebel

1. A patroness of idolatry 1 Kgs. 18: 19.
2. Vengeful and unforgiving. 1 Kgs. 19. 2; Nah. 3:1-4.
3. A murderess 1 Kgs. 21:5-13
4. Incited or manipulated her husband to evil. 1 Kings 9:21-22.
5. Vain 2 Kings 9:30
6. Practises Whoredom (Prostitution) and witchcraft. 2 Kings 9:21-22.
7. Full of hypocrisies Rev 17:1-4.
8. Through her whoredoms people become indifferent (Hos 5:4) and her victims (Hos. 4:12). Ministry of the devil is to steal, to kill and to destroy (John 10:10a). Witchcraft or the Jezebel Spirit is the clearing or coordinating center of the above ministry and characteristics.

Operations of the Spirit of Jezebel (or Operations Witchcraft.)

1. Pursue and promote agenda that opposes God i.e. idolatry 1 Kings.
2. Aim to murder God Prophets and worshipers. 1 Kings 18:13, 19:2.
3. Promote social injustice and depriving the poor of his right. 1 Kings 21:1-14.

4. Manipulates and controls rulers and governance.
5. Rev. 2:20- Seduction of God's people to sexual sin and idolatry (i.e. eating of sacrifices to idols).
6. Practiced prostitution and seduces. 2 King 9:22, 30.
7. Jezebel Usurps authority - 1 Kings 21:7-8.

Other Operation of Witchcraft: 1 Sam. 15:16-23

* Witches rebel against God, pursue agenda outside that of God.

Vs 3. - God had an agenda for Saul. Saul did the contrary

Vs 20. - Saul lied, exhibited deception (He did not utterly destroy)

Vs 23. -Rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft.

* Witchcraft aims to promote disobedience and rebellion in the hierarchy of power- witchcraft is highest point in satanic programme. It is very effective in satanic activities.

Activities of the Spirit of Jezebel (Witchcraft) Ps. 59

4 Vs 1 Opposition to the gospel of Christ

* Vs.2- They are workers of iniquity and are bloody

* Vs.3 - They lie in wait to destroy souls without a cause

* Vs 4 - Impersonification

*Vs.6- They feel that they are hidden

*Vs.12- They are proud, use curses and lying. (They curse with coded language Pretend to bless in hypocrisy).

*Vs. 15 -They wander to look for meat to eat, kill prophets of God

She is deceptive - It is a religious spirit-

Prophetic Judgment on Jezebel Spirit

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Job 34:21-30 | 4. Is. 49:24 & 25 |
| 2. Ez. 13:20-23 | 5. Micah 5:8 - 15 |
| 3. Nahum 4-7, 15 | 6. Zech. 13:1 |

7. Ps. 69:22-25

How to protect our house from witchcraft infiltration.

Ps. 101:4-7; John 10:27 - 30.

Deliverance from the spirit of Jezebel

- (a). There must be clear understanding that Jezebel is not a human being but a spirit that is personified as a woman. Rev. 2:20; Rev. 17:3.
- (b). We do not wrestle against flesh and blood but against principalities and powers.
- (c). We need therefore to begin from repentance and renunciation of her activities in our lives.
- (d). Let the Elders in the city repent for allowing her the church and city.
- (e). Separation from her influences - Rev. 18:4; Jer. 51:
- (f). Engage in spiritual warfare against her. Isa. 47.

WATER SPIRITS, THEIR ACTIVITIES AND THEIR EFFECTS

Introduction

The water spirit kingdom is an arm of darkness. Satan has used it to challenge the purposes of God on the face of the earth. It lays claim to creation, dominion, power and wealth Ezek. 29:3, Ezek. 32:1-8. This kingdom has challenged the Sovereignty of God in the lives of people. This study is by no means exhaustive but is an attempt, to expose the activities and networking of the water spirit in families, communities, cities and nations of the world.

Before creation, the surface of the earth was covered with water: Gen 1:1-2

70% of world surface is water.

70% of Human body is water.

The whole earth and the entire world is founded on water. Ps. 24. 1-2 God established his own throne upon the water. Ps. 29:3, 10, Rev. 4:6. The foundation of the earth was covered with the deep as with a garment. Ps. 104:5-6.

In the light of these biblical references, we can understand why Satan in his rebellion against God has established the power base of his kingdom inside the waters. Isa. 14:12-17; Rev. 13:1-8.

The manifestation of the water spirits

As their name implies, water spirits are found in pools of water, seas, rivers, oceans, as well as in the human body, which is made up of 70% water. These Spirits do not easily let go of their victims or area of operation. Mk. 5:1-13. They always put up fierce resistance in deliverance. Jesus and his disciples were resisted when they were crossing the river to deal with the case of the man with a legion of water spirits. Mk. 4:35-41.

The Network of the Water Spirit

The full picture of the whore that she upon many waters is in Rev. 17:1-6. This one spirit working out the same mystery of iniquity everywhere. All forms of Idolatry originate from the water. The network include: individuals,

families, communities, cities and nations. She can equally be referred to as the queen of heaven. Jer. 44:27-28.

People serve this same spirit in line with their different traditions, cultures or backgrounds. One thing that is common in the activities of this spirit is immorality and seduction. Nations and people are governed under her influence and power. Nineveh. Nah. 3: 1-7; Babylon, Isa. 47:1-15; Egypt, Ezek. 32:1-18; Tyre & Sidon, Ezek. 27.28. The Serpent was introduced as the most subtle beast among all the beasts of the field, Gen. 3:1. It brought the fall of man.

The serpent is usually used as a symbol of water spirit worship e g. in Idemili L.G.A. in Anambra State of Nigera.

Some people communities, towns are named after the serpent, which implies water spirit dedication: (Eke - Umueke B Umuagwa in Ibo Land, Olokun; Yoruba land and Mammy Water in the other parts of Nigeria

Wombs of mothers are the strongest alters of water spirits in families; some of them have thrones in the water. Buying and selling are controlled by this spirit. Merchants, businessmen and women are rich through the abundance of her delicacies. Rev. 18:3.

The outworking of this network is done at close range. Their human agents are all around us; in our families, environment, fellowship, and place of work, business, churches etc. Their first allegiance is to their spirit master and not to their natural family. For instance, the legal rights that the water spirits have in a mother /sister/father or any close relation can influence them and use them to cause afflictions in their natural families.

The network of the water spirits can be likened to the school Board where the posting, transfer and promotion of teachers are done, using files, documents and records at their headquarters without consulting the teacher. Likewise, the water spirits can call up your records from their computers, magic mirrors etc. in the water to deal with you without your knowledge.

Methods of Initiation into Water Spirit Cults:

Rev. 17:2, Rev. 18:13, Nah. 3:4

1. Through family ties - Idolatry and ancestral worship
2. By association in schools, through friends, eating, exchanging gifts committee of friends, making uniform in burial ceremonies, marriages and various ceremonies.
3. Different forms and levels of fornication.
 - (a). Sexual sin - incest, adultery, fornication, Homosexuality - Lesbianism
 - (b). Spiritual fornication, through divination, sorceries, enchantments, Palm readings, witchcraft, all forms of false churches, cults, bathing in water by false prophets.

Idolatry

The bases of all Idolatry is a marriage covenant, worship of streams, rivers, stones. fishes. Ps.106:28. Dedications, Sacrifices, incisions, altars, visiting herbalist, rulers and elders in search of power for protection. Securing the land, women looking for fruit of the womb.

Ogbanje cults:

Some of the examples of the dedications into ogbanje Cult in Africa are as follows:-

- Cutting of body and drinking blood (some parts of Bendel)
- Cutting off the top of the smallest finger. (Ikwuano- Umuahia)
- Bathing at streams at the night, food, drink, personal clothing sacrifices in the water, cutting nails and palm reading - wearing the skull of a monkey or tortoise around your neck. Ndi uke. Ndi otu, spiritual husband, spiritual wife, ilo uwa (reincarnation). All these familiar spirits are used by the mysteries of all witchcraft and Sorceries to work out the mystery of her iniquity in keeping generations of families in bondage.

The Effects of Water Spirits:

1. Broken homes and marriages (Divorce).
2. Problem in marriage.
3. Loss of Desire for partner - Constant quarrelling.

4. All forms of sexual abuse in dream- immorality.
5. Fibroid as a result of witchcraft - womb not able to retain seed.
6. Barrenness - late marriage - unstable marriages..
7. Juvenile delinquencies, stubbornness of children - disobedience to parents - lies fighting-promiscuity-
8. Lives, possessions, inheritance, destinies are tied in the water. Nah. 2:6-13
9. Failure in God's work - failure of churches
10. Business failures.
11. Witchcraft and all forms of spiritual and manipulation in the spirit. Nah.3:14, Ps. 97:7, Isa. 42:17.

Methods of Dealing with the Water Spirit:

1. Get record of your involvement by seeking the Lord fasting and praying, asking questions, inquisitive prayers.
2. Repentance and confession of sins towards God - Ancestral Sins, dedications covenants, marriages, vows, promise, blood guiltiness, devotions, satanic priesthood etc. Dan. 9:3-19, Neh.
3. Atonement by the blood of Jesus Christ Rev 5:9-10
4. Renounce the Covenants and dedications. Divorce the marriages, Gal. 2:20, Col. 1:2 Eph. 5:25-27.
5. Deal with the tokens of the covenants in the waters, on the land in your body. Command the spirits to leave your body. Isa. 44:25.
6. Spiritual warfare in dealing with the records in the heavens and water speak into the elements, sun, moon and star. Ps. 21:6-8.
7. Get an anointed man of God who has a calling in this area to pray for you.
8. Continue in spiritual warfare with step 2-6 until you begin to see the physical manifestation of your restoration. The battle of David of Keilah and Ziklag Ps 18:15 Isa. 47, Nah. 2:6-13; Isa 27.1: Rev. 18, Ezek 29, Rev. 5.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, with these illustration we can see that the entire creation can be shaken from the waters, in fulfilment of last days prophecy in Hag. 2:6-9.

Spiritual warfare in Egypt. God instructed Moses to start from River Nile, the power base of Pharaoh and the magicians. Exod. 7:14-25.

It was after the judgment of the great whore that sits upon many waters, that the marriage supper of the Lamb was called. For her wife has made herself ready for the supper. Rev. 19:1-10. Manipulation in the spirit. Nah 3:14, Ps. 16:4,

DEALING WITH WITCHCRAFT

Definition

Witchcraft is the coordinating house of the wish of the devil to steal, kill and destroy. John, 10:10. It has no other function. It involves a satanic ability to take the spirit out of the body of the witch. Since the ability is satanic, it can only steal, kill and destroy. All cults, whether local or foreign, ultimately feed into witchcraft.

Ex 22:18, Lev 19:31,20:6

Characteristics of Witches

From Psalm 59 we learn the following:-

1. Are enemies from which we need deliverance
2. Work iniquity and like blood v.2.
3. Lie in wait for lives and that without a cause v.3.
4. Operate in night hours v.6a
5. Operate as dogs, barking noise in the night 6b.
6. They believe they are hidden v.7.
7. They are proud, and like to curse.
8. Wander up and down looking for meat at night. What kind of meat?
Micah 3:2-3- human meat.
9. God will not slay them yet, He is giving them room to repent. v. 11.
10. V.13-God's patience runs out and He would slay them.

Activities of witches

Psalm 10 describes the same phenomenon but let us see v.7 -10.

1. Sit in lurking places of the villages to murder the innocent v. 8.
2. Use false humility, especially in church, to trap. Nineveh was a city built on witchcraft.

Examine the activities of witchcraft in that city See Nahum 3:1 -4.

3. Bloody covens.
4. Co-ordinate lies and robberies.

5. Pursue with spears and automobiles in the spiritual realm. You may have heard people talking of sudden pain. It could easily be called heart attack and indeed it can be. Often, however it is witchcraft lancing.
6. Use automobiles of people in the spirit realm and that causes damage of such vehicles in the physical realm. Don't enter into a car in the dream.
7. Fill the place with corpses.
8. Uses prostitution to sell families and nations. (Wherever there is a lot of prostitution, there is a lot of witchcraft).
9. Use abominable filth.
10. Use seduction.

Other Activities

1. They trap with food Ps. 141:4. You are not allowed to eat in the dream. Physical food is for the physical body. If you eat in the dream you are eating witchcraft food when you are not a witch i.e. 'Eating unworthily'. It leads to weakness and sickness.
2. Are cannibalistic - Micah 3:2-3.
3. Wear spider's web - Is 59:4-8. A feeling of spider web across the face. This is satanic hindrance.
4. Operate with and as unclean birds and beast. All the animals and birds God asked Israel to abstain in the Old Testament, are the ones they use. Lev 11:13-20, 27, 42, Deut. 14:11 -19.
5. Infiltrate churches to ensnare - Ez. 13.7-10, 16-19.

A typical witch in the Bible was Jezebel -2 Kings 9:22.

'She'

- * Was whore and very seductive
- * Was murderess
- * Was manipulating and dominating her husband, family and nation.
- * Sought the life of the men of God.
- * Promoted idolatry and vices
- * Hated prayers and praying men.
- * Died under God's fierce judgment.

- * Even the contaminated seed can be dangerous e.g.- Athaliah, daughter of Jezebel who slaughtered all her grandchildren but one. 2 Kings 11:1-3; 2 Chr. 22.

Jezebel appears again in Rev. 2:20-21.

She was the confidence of the leadership of the church, is given position of responsibility and quickly spreads seduction and idolatry.

How to deal with witchcraft

Protecting your house/ child from witchcraft.

- (i). Dedicate your house, children and everything you have to God formally. Jn. 10:22-30.
- (ii). Train your child not to eat food indiscriminately in school, church and train him/her to bless and thank God for each food he/she eats.
- (iii). Proclaim Ps. 101:4-8 over your house. This word has consistently driven out witches from Christian homes.
- (iv). Refuse witchcraft food. 1 Cor. 10:20-21. You eat in the table of the Lord and therefore can't eat from the table of devils. See also. Ps 141:4.
- (v). Note that the activities of dogs must not affect the church Ex. 11:7. Proclaim this over your life and dogs will stop pursuing you in your dream.
- (vi). Spiritual litigation Rom. 8:33-34. No person has a right to accuse you.

Prophetic Judgment on Witchcraft

1. God wills to expose and break them in pieces. Job. 34:21-30.
2. Exposure, judgment and disgrace Nah.3:1-7 & 19.
3. God wills to cut off witchcraft from the land using the church. Mic. 5:8-15.
4. God wills to make their coven and table snares. Ps. 69:22-25; Rom. 11:9-10.
5. Judgment on witches operating in churches. 2 Tim. 3:8-9; 2 Kings 9:30-33; Rev. 2:20-23.

Conclusion

Note that witches/wizards can repent. Acts 8:9 -24.

Encourage repentance. However, after repentance, a minister of God must be called in to minister deliverance and cast out the demon, because witchcraft is a spirit. If they fail to repent then God may choose to apply his judgment that says 'suffer not a witch to live' Exodus 22:18.

RIGHTEOUSNESS AND DELIVERANCE

Text. Heb. 12:14-17; Luke 1:68-75.

Introduction

Deliverance has become a regular feature in Christian programmes (Camps and Conferences). Indeed many have made deliverance a revenue - yielding venture. But it is important for us to understand the mind of God and the linkage between Righteousness and Deliverance.

Deliverance: meaning and concept:

Jn 11:44, Isa. 58:6-8, Acts 12:1-10

- * Release or setting free from bondage or captivity of a person, people or place.
- * It suggests that somebody or something had lost his/its freedom (either of action or thought) or liberty to act or to serve freely.

Deliverance from What?

- a. Darkness/ignorance (of God's words and his power) Hosea 4:6; Matt. 22:29.
- b. Enemies (spiritual, physical) Luke 1:71, 74).
 - * The enemy does not want you to relate with God.
 - * Does not also want to release you from his own services unto the service of God Matt. 21:2, 3.

How did man come into captivity or bondage? Rom. 6:16-30

Man became a servant of sin by act of the will expressed in words, choice and desperation See Gen. 19:17-23, 30-36.

Righteousness: Meaning and Concept 1 Jn. 3:7

- * Doing what is morally right
- * Morally justifiable having an attitude that is right towards all things and situations.
- * It is the nature of God by which human actions, thoughts and dispositions are weighed.

- * It is an essential requirement for acceptance by God. Isa. 33:15 18; Ps. 15.

(ii) The absence of righteousness suggests the presence of sin which produces an envelope of darkness. Darkness is the hiding place of demons that enforce captivity to Satan.

C. Relationship between Righteousness and

Deliverance -1 Jn 15-10.

Every deliverance process must first begin with repentance and confession of sin. This ensures the removal of the cover of darkness- i.e. the home of evil spirits.

Once deliverance is carried out, the individual is encouraged to practice righteousness by the word of God through (a) Active fellowship, personal Bible study and prayers. This also is an act of the will Rom.6:19-22.

D. Examples of men who practiced righteousness and obtained deliverance.

- (i). Daniel Dan. 6:4, 21-23
- (ii). Joseph - Gen. 39:7-13, 41:39-46
- (iii). 3 Hebrew friends - Dan. 3.14-18; 24-27
- (iv). Paul - Acts 20:20, 25, 26, 33 and 34.

E. Personal Challenge: John 14:30.

The devil will only be attracted to you if he has his property (sin) in you. Your surest safeguard against this is this deliberate activity in Eph. 6:11-18. Always consciously put them on.

Conclusion

No true deliverance takes place or is sustained outside righteous living. If you have undergone deliverance you must practice righteousness otherwise you will suffer a relapse.

SETTING THE CAPTIVES FREE

Bible Reading: Isaiah 14:12-17, Isaiah 61.1-7.

Bible Text: John 11:44b- Loose him and let him go.

Aim of Teaching:

- (i). To seek to be set free
- (ii). To go and set men free so that they can excel for God.

Introduction

A captive is a person taken prisoner, kept as a prisoner, one that is held to the ground by a cable; one that cannot get away easily and is therefore open to persuasion (Dictionary definition of a captive).

Note: A captive is not free. There are several types of captivity namely - captivity to sin, culture, tradition and demonic manipulations etc.

It is important to understand, as intercessors that what is seen in the physical is controlled in the realm of the spirit. Many lives are controlled and directed from the Spirit realm. The aim of intercession is to stand in the gap to plead with God to intervene in the affairs of men until those under satanic captivity are loosened or set free.

Origin of Captivity

The author of captivity is Satan, the enemy. In creation, God made everything good. Gen. 1:31.

Gen. 1:28 Man was to have dominion and subdue all thing.

Rev. 4:11 - God made man for His pleasure and glory.

Gen.3 - Sin separated man from God

Satan brought sin and man become a servant of sin. This is the beginning of captivity.

Result:

- (i). Break of fellowship between man and God. Man lost his position and failed to exercise authority and Dominion.

- (ii). Satan took man's authority to subdue and have dominion.
- (iii). Every man is under certain level of captivity because of sin.

Satan together with his subordinates rule in darkness as seen below: Isa. 14:12, certain angels rebelled and were cast out of heaven, they now constitute.

- | | |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| (a). Principalities | (d). Spirit of wickedness in high |
| (b). Powers of this world | places |
| (c). Rulers of darkness | |

- * These spirits live in the mid heaven. They rule from there. They do not live in human beings.

Other Satanic Spirits

- (a). Territorial Spirit

These are spirits of darkness that rule over cities and territories e.g. Prince of Persia and Prince of Gracia Dan 1:13, 20. For every nation or city, there is a prince. These spirits occupy the first heavens (Ps. 19:1). The first heaven is where the sun, moon and Stars exist. It is the sky/firmament.

- (b). Elemental Spirits: These are demons. Mark. 16:9, Luke 8:30: Luke 11:24-26. They are earth-bound. Demons possess and live in human beings.

Demons receive strength and information from the 1st and 2nd heavens and their activities are determined from there.

Activities of the Captor (Satan)

1. John 10:10a - To kill, to steal and to destroy.
2. Isaiah 14: 16-17-
 - (a). To weaken nations
 - (b). To make the earth to tremble
 - (c). To make the world a wilderness
 - (d). To destroy cities
 - (e). To hold lives captive (make men prisoners)

3. All forms of false religion and heresies are activities of these spirits.
4. Entice, torment and compel one to sin, fight against peace, bring evil thought and worry.
5. Fight against harmony in homes and promote strife.
6. Bring infirmities and sickness.
7. Inconsistency in our walk with God.
8. Social tendencies, emotional attitudes (e. g. anger, hatred, bitterness, resentment) are the work of evil spirit. Prov. 25:8.
9. Promote deception and lies.
10. Infertility in Marriage
11. Desolation in the land
12. Promote covetousness and materialism
13. Godless living among those in authority.

Sources of Captivity

Accursed things (e.g. Achan Joshua 7:1 accursed things bring people under captivity)

What are the accursed things or gifts in your home?

- (i). Idolatry Ex. 34:7, Ex. 20:3-7.
- (ii). Hereditary sins (Ex. 34:7, 20:5) - (Ancestral covenant, Libation, Occultic practices).
- (iii). Curses: 1 Sam. 2:27-34, 1 Sam. 22:23-34 & 1 Kings 2:26-27. Joshua 6:26-27, 1 Kings 16:33 & 34.
- (iv). Culture
 - (a). Events during traditional marriages, child birth and death ceremonies.
 - (b). Festivals e.g. new yam festivals, masquerades festivals etc.
- (v). Dedication to Marine Spirit through sacrifices
- (vi). Witchcraft - The spirit that excels in wickedness.

Symptoms of Captivity

- i. Failure to fulfil God's redemptive plan for an individual or city.
- ii. Inability to live a holy life.
- iii. Backsliding tendencies.

- iv. Persistent sin which defy prayer and fasting
- v. A community or city that does not desire God.
- vi. Premature deaths
- vii. Peculiar sickness in family
- viii. Unstable marriages in family
- ix. Sexual perversion and Poverty etc.

What must be done to free the captive?

There is hope for the captive from the scriptures.

- (i). Is. 49:24 -26 Lawful captive shall be delivered.
- (ii). Col.2:13-14 - Blotting out handwriting of ordinances and nailing them to the cross.
- (iii). Gal. 3:13-14- Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law.
- (iv). Heb.8:12-13 - God made the old covenant obsolete and new covenant in Jesus Christ is ours.

Processes in setting captives free.

A things to do in the process

- i. Names of the person (what does this names (s) mean)
- ii. Date of Birth (what significant things happened or were done during your birth? e.g. were you raised and presented to the sun? Where was your umbilical cord buried?).
- iii. Do you read stars (derived from cosmic powers)
- iv. Do you go to palmist?
- v. What is your village?
- vi. What are the idols in your village and father's compound?
- vii. Have you been to a native doctor - What were done there?
- viii. Are there curses on the family?
- ix. Are there altars raised in your father's house?
- x. Is the family dedicated to any god?
- xi. Have you practiced occultism?
- xii. Have you been to any white garment church?
- xiii. Are you involved in sexual perversions e.g. incest?
- xiv. Are marriages in the family usually successful?

xv. Do the family drink heavily?

B. The setting free process proper - John 11:44.

- i. Make atonement on behalf of the person at the throne of God.
- ii. Lead the person to repentance, through confession and renunciation
- iii. Address the prince of darkness over the village or family of the person.
- iv. Break covenant entered into (may be bondage, token, terms).
- v. Frustrate the tokens, Terms and conditions of living after the covenant.
- vi. Bolt out the handwriting of ordinance with the Blood of Jesus
- vii. Bind and overthrow the power of darkness
- viii. Speak to or command the demons in the person's life to leave
- ix. The person should be filled with the Holy Spirit
- x. Holy living must be encouraged.
- xi. Encourage the person to grow in faith through fellowship, Bible studies and prayer.

Conclusion

Whatever man lost in Adam was regained in Jesus Christ who paid the price for our release. No man should hence forth remain in bondage or captivity.

REDEEMING THE LAND

Introduction

As a result of the sin of Adam and Eve the Land was cursed (Gen 3:17). In addition our own sins and that of our fathers e.g. idolatry also contribute to the pollution of the land (Isa. 42:17, Deut. 18:9-12).

In pollution of the land (Isa.42: 17, Deut. 18:9-12). A cursed land can be identified through bareness, poor harvest, stunted growth of people, lack of development, backwardness, poverty, unfruitfulness of the word of lord.

Land dedication.

Land in the scripture are dedicated in the following ways:

1. Building alters - Gen. 8:20; Gen. 12:7-8; Gen. 13:14-18; Gen. 28:22.
2. Covenants - Gen. 9:13; Gen. 17:10.
3. Sacrifice - Gen. 15:8-18.

Pollution

Land is polluted through satanic activities by doing the exact opposite of what is stated above. This is how Satan brings a land into bondage. Notice that the devil copies God's pattern and perverts same for his purposes.

- (a). Alters 1Kings 13:2-5
- (b). Sacrifice Ps. 106:37-40
- (c). Covenants Isa. 28:14-15
- (d). Sexual pollutions Lev. 18

How can Land be redeemed?

Through Jesus Christ and his offering on the cross Gal 3:13.

Who can redeem the land?

Corporate work of believers - Matt. 16:18, Lev.25:25-30.

Practical aspects of land redemption,

- (a). Check historical background by seeking the Lord and using enquiry.
Neh. 1:1-4. Neh.2:11-17.
- (b). By asking questions from elders
- (c). By checking history books and archives.

Note: The need to involve indigenes and in particular those who have spiritual authority over the land/place. (Judges 6:25-27, Ezek. 22:30).

Process of Redemption.

- (a). Repentance -Neh. 1:5-11; Neh.9; Dan. 9; Ezra.9. Let some of the elders bring repentance over the land as custodians of the law of the land.
- (b). Priestly atonement by the blood of Jesus Christ. Heb.5:1-4; Zech. 13:1-2; Heb.9:22; Col. 1:16-20.
- (c). Renunciation of the deities and covenants over the land.-e.g. Ancestral Covenants, Sacrifice, Vows, Promises, Token, Alters, Agreements etc.
- (d). Prophetic proclamation of redemption. (Rev.5:1-14; 2 kings2:18-22.)

How to Retain the Redemption

- * Occupy till I come - Luke 19:13
- * Priestly intercession - 1 Pet. 2:9; Rev. 5:9-10; Rev. 1:5-6
- * Building company of -Ezek 22:30 prayer men (watchmen) - Isa.62:1-10.

Conclusion.

The level of redemption required for any land depends on the level of past dedications. These have to be addressed after careful research and seeking of the Lord's face for direction. A land that is redeemed frees itself from bondage before making all positive developments possible. The redemption of the land allows the free move of the spirit of the living God.

STRATEGY FOR COMMUNITY CITY DELIVERANCE

Introduction

Every city or community has a redemptive gift. Each must seek to show forth this gift as a token of having entered into God's redemptive move (Ps. 60:6-12). No city or community on earth has ever grown naturally into God's move. There is always some warfare to do. These warfare (Jer. 1:9-10) has become necessary because the bible describes the foundations of the whole earth as being out of course (Ps. 82:5) These description does not fit into God's plan and foundation as seen in 1 Cor. 3:11 and 2 Tim.2:19. The growing need to redeem the land (Joshua 14: 12a) is a major foundational principle for spiritual, and even some time, physical warfare over cities today. Thus, the target of every spiritual warfare over cities include:-

1. To subdue the enemy - Joshua 17:12-13
2. To take the city Joshua 17:14-18
3. To secure it for our God 2 Sam 10:12

The institutional enemy in every city is Satan in his governmental system - Idolatry (Zech.13:2). Remember that idolatry removes a people from the will of God.

How to start.

Prayerfully conduct a study of the city/community to show the following: The redemptive gift of the community/city, Major idols served, demons worshipped and covenants kept. The spirit that operates in the place and its activities/influences of generational sin-pest and present.

Spiritual Mapping:

Prayerfully do a mapping of the places showing Major locations of strongholds (including strongmen and women). Major Gates (spiritual and physical) places of historic importance .Brief history of the community/city.

Strategy and timing:

Prayerfully determine God's timing and strategy attack.

Prayer network.

Institute prayer network for the community/city as follows:

Assemble intercessors, give them the information gathered and commence a siege over the city. (Joshua 8:3-4; Ps. 63:5-61; Matt. 13:24-25; 25:1-6). Gather the pastors within the community/city, give the information and cause them to commence praying together. Get a combined team of pastors and intercessors to commence praying, commence a city wide praying arrangement with fasting. Engage in constant strategic spiritual warfare.

Direction of Prayer.

1. Take responsibility over the community/city in prayer and bring its sin under the light of repentance and pray until people are led into repentance (Zech. 7:14; Zech. 13:1).
2. Address specific covenants by name and break them. Find out names of the idols worshipped and repent of them specifically. Men have authority over where they live. Then speak to the idols on behalf of your people (Gen. 1:28, Luke 10:19, Jer.29:7).
3. Make atonement with the blood of Jesus Christ and use the blood to break all the satanic covenant and courses (Col. 1:14, Gal 3:13).
4. Reject and renounce the speaking of the covenants and their demon spirits (Heb. 8:13; 9:11-17)
5. Engage in prophetic spiritual warfare against the territorial spirits and demons, addressing them by name, while classifying those you do not know. Bind and cast them out and restrain them from returning to the community/city.
6. Enter into prophetic praying for the community/city. Plant truth and righteousness (Zech 8:16-17) and replace the covenant you have broken with positive ones
7. Proclaim jubilee over the community/city- (Lev 25).

Other Regular Activities:

Prayer evangelism- regular visits by intercessors to the community/city to pray; Prayer walk- walking and praying within designated places of the community/city (Joshua 1:3) and prophetic actions doing in the city what God has specifically requested are some of the ways of sustaining the gains of

community/city deliverance. Note: These steps could also be applied prior to taking the city.

Qualifications of the deliverance Army.

They must have a determination and zeal that produce from understanding of the will of God. (Josh. 14:6-12), they must be armed with the word of God Josh. 14:6-9). They must be dead to sin and alive in Christ they must have been cut off from their evil roots (2Cor.6:17-18). Their homes in terms of relationships must be Christian standard (no fighting, quarrelling, malice, etc.) they must have (a) attained Gal. 2:20; (b) Knocked off Gal.5:19-21 and (c) built upon Gal. 5:22-23.

Conclusion

Our community/cities are very important in God's programme (Jonah 4:11). God wants to redeem them to himself through us. It is when a people make themselves available that God can use them. Become interested in the redemption of your community/city today.

THE JOSHUA GENERATION

Introduction

Several thousand years ago, two million people who had just passed through the wilderness stood at the bank of the River Jordan, they needed a Joshua to carry them across. Today, we stand as a people at the bank, of the Jordan seeking a Joshua generation to take us as a people across our Jordan.

Definition

What is Joshua generation? Joshua generation is that generation of people who will lead their generation out of the wilderness across their Jordan into the promised inheritance. They are the generation that will be trained to provide spiritual leadership.

Characteristics of Joshua Generation

1. They will be servant to some leaders - Ex. 24-13; Ex. 32:17, Ex. 33:11; Num. 11:28.
2. They will be trained to fight and become warriors - Ex. 17:9-15; Ex. 32:17b.
3. They will be involved in raising other leaders as themselves - Josh. 4:4.
4. They will bring about a change of strategy in subduing the land.
Example spy the land (Spiritual mapping). Num. 13:16, John. 2:1, Josh. 7:2.
5. They will never be discouraged by the negative reports of others, they will wholly follow the Lord - Num. 14:6-10.
6. A people that will have another spirit - Num. 14:20-24, 30
7. They will be obedient to leadership and will not rebel like others.
8. The generation in whom is the spirit - Num 27:18
9. This generation will be raised up through intercession Numbers 27:15-17.
10. Ability to rise up early to seek the Lord - Joshua 3:1.

Activities of the Joshua Generation

There is need to observe carefully the differences in operation between Moses ministry and that of Joshua in order to appreciate why God must raise a Joshua generation in the church.

- (1). They will bring about a change in leadership in the Church and in the government of the Nation.
- (2). Changing of the one man's pattern of leadership.
- (3). A proper networking in leadership - Josh. 1:10-11
- (4). They will restore orderliness in the Church and this will affect the Nation. Josh. 6:2-10. Joel 2:7-8 John. 17:21
- (5). God will use them to deal with the issue of rebellion against his purposes. Josh, 1:16-18.
- (6). The church needs circumcision because there are many millions born in the wilderness that had not been circumcised. Jos. 5:2. God will use them for the circumcision.
- (7). They will demonstrate the work of the Lord by forsaking human ideologies and methods. Josh. 5:13-15.
- (8). They will bring different battle strategies to deal with every warfare. (Example The battle of Jericho and Ai)
- (9). They will wage war to possess the Gates of hell - Matt. 16:18.

Accomplishments of Joshua Generation

1. Crossing Jordan - Josh. 3
2. Subduing Jericho and its king - Josh. 6
3. Building memorials - Josh. 4:20-24.
4. Dealt with sins that troubled Israel - Josh. 7:18-21.
5. They dealt with the heaven lies - Josh. 10:11 -14.
6. They subdued the, land, waters, the heavens, the kings, thrones, the people, gates, cities, Balaam etc.
7. They carried out prophetic action, Josh. 4:20.
8. Brought the people into their inheritance and divided their possessions among them.

Conclusion

It takes a Moses Generation to bring the people into their wilderness but it takes a Joshua to open their Jordan and bring them into their inheritance in God.

THE ARMY OF THE LORD

Text: Jer. 51:20-24, Joel 2.1 - 11.

Introduction

The whole world lies in contention. There exists between light and darkness, good and evil. Each camp has its strategies for taking full control and its agents for enforcing their goals.

An Army: Recruitment and Training

Army - A group of men/women trained in the act of warfare and deployed to fight for a cause (political, economic or spiritual).

- The distinguishing features of an army is the strict emphasis on physical and mental discipline. Joel 2:7, 8.
- Just as individuals are recruited or conscripted into an army, the same applies to the spiritual. There are two dimensions of the army.
 - i. Spiritual - made of the holy and the demonic, Eph. 6:12; Matt. 26:52-53; 2 Kings 6:16, 17.
 - ii. Physical - made of human beings. 2 Chron. 20:14-22;
- The recruitment into the Lord's army comes by:
 - i. The process of the new birth 2 Cor. 5:15-21
 - ii. The placement of a burden on the Christian. Judges 6:12-14; 1 Sam. 29-36 (Conscription)

The Army of the Lord: Mission and Activities

I. A disciplined army keeps its vision in focus and faithfully pursues same. Josh. 5:13-, 6:2

- Its mission is to recover the possession that God gave but which the enemy had stolen. 1 Sam. 30:18-19.
- To enforce the will of God and his rule on the earth as it is in heaven- Isa. 49:24-26
- To set free those that have been held captives by the enemy - Isa.49:24-26.
- To demonstrate the kingdom lifestyle on the earth.- Luke 11:1-2.

II. The strategic Activities of the Army of the Lord is:

- Intercession and prophetic action - Josh.6.3-5
- Holy and consistent living - Josh.3:5
- Evangelism - Matt. 28:19.

III. Their weapons are varied but basically spiritual. 2 Cor. 10:4, 5.

- The word of God Jer. 1:9, 10
- The words supplied by God (spoken) Rev. 12:11.
- The blood of Jesus, Personal Testimony Eph. 6:13-18.
- The quality of life lived.
- The battle ground is
 - (a). The mind
 - (b). The public and private places

Conclusion.

There is no mutuality in this spiritual contest. It is either you are on the Lord's side or the devil's. One thing is certain, they who have joined the army of the Lord are on the victory side. Joel 2:7-8.

THE CYRUS COMPANY

Introduction

Cyrus was a heathen king raised by God to carry out a definite assignment in the life of the nation of Israel Isa. 44:28-45:4. He was called in righteousness not because he was righteous but because he would carry out God's righteous plan of redemption. Thus, the Cyrus company is a prophetic company. (Isa. 41:2).

1. Why do we need a Cyrus company?

- (a). The Lord has promised (us) a company of leaders who will have anointing of Cyrus and the heart of David.
- (b). To deal with wickedness in the cities of the world.
- (c). To subdue Kings and Kingdoms. Isa.45:1.
- (d). To install Godly leadership in the nations.
- (e). Leadership and administration in the nation is in shambles.
- (f). Our nation and her resources are in captivity.
- (g). To bring restoration (Joel. 2:25-27).
- (h). To bring to pass God's council in the nation - Ps. 149:6-9; Isa. 46:10.
- (i). To exalt the God of heaven.
- (j). To exalt the God of heaven.

2. Ministry of the Cyrus Company.

They will minister as Priests.

- (a). Rebuild the house of the Lord -Ezra 1:2.
- (b). Carry out prophetic proclamations -Ezra. 1:1-2.
- (c). Restoring the vessels of the house of the Lord - Ezra. 1:7-11; 2 Tim. 2:20, 21.

As Kings:

- (a). Bringing godly rule over the nation's administration.
- (b). Rebuilding the desolations of many generations - Isa 61:4; 58:11-12.
- (c). Releasing their sources of the nations for God's purposes.
- (d). Restoring the economy of the nations. -Ezra, 1:4, 7.
- (e). Dealing with the gates, losing the Loins of Kings –Isa 45:1
- (f). Bringing deliverance to captives at all levels. Isa. 45:13b.

3. Qualities of the Cyrus Company.

- (a). They have enabling ministries -Ezra. 1:5-9.
- (b). They possess Zeal of the Lord. 2 Kings 10:16.
- (c). Obedient to God. Deut. 28:1, 15.
- (d). They will have burden. Neh.1.
- (e). They will be honest and sincere.

4. Operational strategies of the Cyrus Company.

- (a). They will do things in order. Joel.2:7-8. Rebuild the temple before the Nation.
- (b). 2 Chron. 36:22. Their hearts will be stirred by God in order that:
 - (i). They will have working relationship with God. Isa. 45:2.
 - (ii). They will raise the understanding of God's people on how to bring finance in the house of the Lord.
 - (iii). They will teach and demonstrate to God's people how to bring resources into the house of God.
 - (iv). They will follow the leading of the lord.
 - (v). Their mandate will always come from the Lord.

Levels of Involvement of the Cyrus Company.

They will be involved in all levels of leadership both secular and spiritual.

Conclusion.

There are certain things God cannot release until the right kind of people are in place. It is therefore the responsibility of the church to pray until God raises this company to fulfil His purposes.

SPIRITUAL SPOUSES.

Introduction.

God's intention is that marriage between man and woman should be in the physical realm. But the devil by his manipulations has put many under terrible bondage by involving them, some times without their active participation, in spiritual marriage.

Origin of Spirit Spouses. Gen. 6:1-6.

Sons of God went into the daughters of men and had children by them.

Examine the identity of these "sons of God" Job. 1:6, 2:1, 38:7. So these are spirit beings. The parameters of these interactions can be summarized as follows:

- i. Sons of God entered into (had sexual intercourse) with the daughters of men.
- ii. These sons of God chose whichever daughter of men they would.
- iii. These intercourse led to children
- iv. The children were supernatural and wicked.
- v. All these occurred after the fall and **NOT BEFORE SIN.**
- vi. God vehemently disapproved of it and pronounced destruction on the whole system.

This principle explains the spirit husband and spirit wife problem. The New Testament also alludes to this wicked intercourse. Jude 6-7. What is meant by angels who kept not their first estate? The answer is in v. 7 even as Sodom and Gomorrah. In like manner, giving themselves over to fornication and going after strange flesh .i.e. these angels left their proper position. (Angels are not to marry) and did what Sodom and Gomorrah did fornication and going after strange flesh. See also 2 Pet. 2:4-7. Once again the sinning angels are mentioned alongside with Sodom and Gomorrah

Features of the Spirit Spouse Problem

1. Sexual intercourse in the dream
2. Children/pregnancies in the dream.
3. Acts as a hindrance and blocks proper marriage.

4. Responsible for multi breaks in engagements.
5. If at all the person gets married?
 - (a). Instigates marital discords
 - (b). Fights the marriage partner - his/her health, business and generally behaves as a rival spouse.
 - (c). Fights against pregnancy and causes abortions and miscarriages
 - (d). By much grace and prayers a child comes, fights the health and life of the child.

How are Spirit Spouses Acquired?

1. Protection rites: all protection rites of white garment churches-candle water prayers, spirit salts, and waterside ritual - are marriage ceremonies. That is why feasting with rice etc. Usually follows i.e. refreshment follows immediately at the same venue. In these ceremonies the person is married to a spirit higher than the one that was troubling him/her who then acts as a protecting spouse.
2. Traditional dances -maiden dances are marriage dances.
3. Sexual perversion - fornication, adultery, incest, masturbation, lesbianism, homosexuality, pornography. 1 Cor.6:6-18. If the two become one, then what was in one enters the other.
4. Receiving gifts. These gifts amount to marriage tokens and dominies, not from the man or woman who gave, but from the spirit behind the giver. Study this purpose in Gen. 24:21-27. &53-58. Once Rebecca received the gift, she was hooked, not to the servant of Abraham but to Isaac who was behind the gift.
5. Inheriting a satanic priesthood. Priesthood is actually a marriage. That is why Christ is the bridegroom of the Church called the church.
6. Descent from concubinage, prostitution and incest.
7. Hair dressing and adornment are aimed at attracting. They attract both men and spirits.

How to Receive Deliverance from Spirit Spouses.

Luke 1:74-75; Is. 49:24-26.

God has ordained deliverance for us.

1. Repentance, identify the door(s) by which it came and make a thorough repentance. Be specific and mention each person you have been involved with in immorality and ask for forgiveness and cleansing.
2. Renounce and reject whatever tokens/gifts were received in sin. This is often difficult because it will entail throwing away TVs, radios, beds, wrist watches, etc.
3. Plead the atoning and redemptive power of the blood of Jesus -1 Pet. 1:18-19; Col 2
4. Renounce the marriage contract and the so called benefits including the so called protection.
5. Go for spiritual litigation and show reasons why the marriage cannot hold i.e. legal arguments
 - i. Spirits are not allowed to marry, therefore that spirit can't expect to marry, not to talk of marrying you. Matt. 22:29-30.
 - ii. Diverse kinds are not allowed to gender. Lev. 19:19. See the principle in Deut. 25:4 and 1 Tim 5:18. In Deut. It talks about cattle but Paul, applies it (even more correctly) to humans.
 - iii. In case the person that went into that illegal marriage died, that spirit should stop harassing another person. Rom. 7:1-4; 1 Cor. 5:17.
 - iv. Execute the Judgment written against such spirits. Jude, 6.
 - v. You are espoused to Christ alone, He is Jealous over and no other must lay claim on you. 2 Cor. 11:3; Gal. 6:17.
 - vi. Issue a certificate of divorce - Deut. 24:1-4.
 - vii. Reaffirm your proper marriage or the marriage plans God has for you.
 - viii. Go and **SIN NO MORE**.
 - ix. Some may at this point require the casting out of devils.

Conclusion.

God does not only reveal the hidden works of darkness. He also gives us overwhelming victory in Christ Jesus if we would obey Him.

KINGDOM LIFESTYLE.

Introduction.

For God is the King of all the earth -Ps. 47:7. A kingdom is a territory or realm ruled by a king.

Lifestyle is a pattern of living, character, behavior, manner or mannerism.

The Kingdom of God carries the idea that includes all persons regenerated by the gospel or the sphere of God's rule or authority. It is the central theme of message and ministry of Jesus (Matt. 4:17). It is a priority to SEE THE KINGDOM. Lk. 6:24-34; Matt. 5:1-12.

Nature of the kingdom.

- (a). It grows secretly but can be frustrated by other. Matt. 13.
- (b). It takes visible form in the life of those who live by the King's (God's) commands hence the KINGDOM LIFESTYLE.
- (c). The Battle is essential between the kingdom of God and the Kingdom of Satan. It is a continuous battle through the ages Luk. 4:5-7; Eph. 6:12; Matt. 6:9-13. The kingdom of God is bigger than the church and heaven. There is need to possess kingdom mentality as a prerequisite to Kingdom lifestyle. Our place in the Kingdom of heaven will depend upon our faithfulness in manifesting kingdom lifestyle here on earth. (Parable of talents Matt. 25, Lk. 19:11- Dan. 7:12-20).

The Lifestyle.

- I. The teaching of Jesus -Matt. 5, 6, 7. Matt. 5:33b-48. To turn the other cheek, to love our enemies. Matt. 6:1-4; 19-21.
 - (i). Giving secretly, an eternal investment. Matt.6:5-13; Lk. 11:11-13; John, 14:13b-14; John. 16:23-24.
 - (ii). Teaching on Prayer - to be continuous and persistent, unlimited in scope and power. Matt 6:16-18; Lk.4:2-
 - (iii). Fasting-Matt. 6:25-34- Not to set our affections on the necessities of life but daily needs (food, shelter and clothing to be provided as we seek the kingdom). Mark. 10:32-33.
 - (iv). To confess Christ openly - Mark. 5:19
 - (v). To witness to relatives first John. 16:1-6; Lk.12:11-12.

- (vi). Persecute certain but help and grace for every trial assured. Lk. 12:16-34.
- (vii). Right use of treasure and money for the expansion of the kingdom.
- (viii). Handling money transparently, trust and sincerity.

II. Other kingdom lifestyle principles;

- Owing no debt. Matt. 5:25-26.
- No struggling for Position 1Cor. 13:1-13.
- No strife and envy - James 3:16, Ps. 15:1-5.
- Love for one another - sharing material things with others Jn.13.

For 5 times Jesus repeated prayer for love in Jn.17. See Matt. 22:35-40. Love is a new commandment and a mark of identification in the kingdom. Jn. 13:34-35. Despite the prominence given by God, love is missing in doctrinal statements of man, churches or denominations. Most regrettably Love is missing in our lives. Love" doing love actions"

1 Cor. 13. Love lays down life for brethren John 15:12. John. 3:16-18.

- Our relationship with God is affected by our actions and relationship with one another. Matt.10:42. Mk. 4:1.
- The Kingdom is Righteousness, Peace, Joy and Holy Ghost. Rom. 14:17.

Examples in kingdom lifestyle:

- Heb.11 - catalogue of men and women who lived a faithful lifestyle.
- Esther and Mordecai - brought the influence and power of the Kingdom of God to bear on a nation through kingdom lifestyle.
- David - His love for Jonathan and his descendants.

Conclusion.

When the Bible said, let your kingdom come, and your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. When you turn it around, as we begin to do the will of God here on earth, automatically his Kingdom is here with us. The lifestyle of the believer ought to be in conformity with God's Kingdom.

KINGDOM WAY OF DOING BUSINESS

Introduction

The original purpose of God has been that His will be done in every aspect of our lives. In businesses, Christians are called to reflect the purpose and will of God. On the contrary, the enemy, by his methods, has sought to pollute virtually every system especially businesses. The Christian businessman or woman is therefore, challenged to bring to bear God's Kingdom principles in his daily business.

Negative Principles to Avoid in Business

- (a). Wasting Goods/life (Lk. 16:1, Lk. 15:13)
- (b). Unrighteousness (Lk. 16:4-8)
- (c). Laziness/slothfulness (Lk. 16:3; Lk. 19:20-23; Rom. 12:11)
- (d). Unfaithfulness (Lk. 16:1)
- (e). Worldly wisdom (Lk. 16:8)
- (f). Indebtedness (Lk. 16:5-7; Ps. 37:21; Rom13:8)
- (g). Evasion of Taxes/duties (Rom. 8:7)
- (h). Covetousness (Lk. 15:13-15)
- (i). Selfishness (Lk. 12:16-21)

Primary focus in doing kingdom business

Business must be entered into with the primary focus of serving the interest of God and His kingdom. (1 Tim. 6:17-19; Lk. 12:21).

This principle is illustrated in the life of Joseph as he served Pharaoh in Egypt.

Gathering all the money and bringing them into the house of Pharaoh (Gen. 47:13-15).

Bought and brought all the livestock to the house of Pharaoh. (Gen. 47:17)

Subdued the people and the land to Pharaoh (Gen. 47:18-20).

Relocation of the people from the borders to the cities. (Gen. 47:21).

Guaranteed Pharaoh's portion first before the people's (Gen. 47:24)

Made the people realize that they and all they owned had been bought for Pharaoh (Gen.47:23).

Made the people appreciate God's salvation and grace and also willingly accept to serve Pharaoh. (Gen. 47:25)

Made it a law that Pharaoh should have the fifth part of all the harvest in Egypt (Gen. 47:26).

Faithfulness in Kingdom Business

Faithfulness connotes trustworthiness, honesty and integrity. It is one of the major identity marks of any business done in the kingdom way. Some areas of faithfulness in business can be segregated as follows:-

- (i). Faithfulness in little things (Lk. 6:10; Lk. 19:16-17)
- (ii). Faithfulness in much (Lk. 16:10)
- (iii). Faithfulness in the use of money (Lk. 16:11)
- (iv). Faithfulness in true riches (Lk. 16:11B)
- (v). Faithfulness in your own business (Lk. 16:12)

Divine Guidance/Discretion - Ps. 112:5.

Divine guidance is not optional in doing business the kingdom way. However, for this to work effectively in the life of any Christian Businessman, the following Principles must be in place:

Trusting on the Lord (Ps. 37:3, Prov. 3:5-6)

Delighting in the Lord (Ps. 37:4)

Committing the business to God (Ps. 37:5)

Resting in the Lord (Ps. 37:7)

Waiting patiently on the Lord (Ps. 37:7)

Other Pertinent principles that govern kingdom Business

- (1). Sound Business Foundation Isa. 28:16; Matt. 7:24-25
- (2). Raising and Maintaining an Altar in the Business Place Acts. 16:13-15; 1 Tim. 2:8
- (3). Surveying Areas of Partnership with Like-Minded Brethren This principle is illustrated in the life of Peter and Andrew; John and James (Lk. 5:5-10) see also Eccl. 4:9-10.

- (4). Use of Divine Standards Matt. 7:12; Deut. 25:13-16. In all aspects of business life, God requires the same measure, weights and perfect standards.
- (5). Diligence Prov. 10:4-5 Prov. 13:4

Conclusion

Doing business according to God's will and purposes result in the following:-

- ❖ God's name is glorified
- ❖ The business man's soul is secured
- ❖ The kingdom ministry is adequately supported and provided for.

RICHES NOT BY MIGHT

Text: Jer. 17:11, Prov. 28:19-20

Introduction

When God created Adam and Eve, He created a lot of wealth for them. Though man lost all this by disobedience, it is indeed the will of God that we should prosper. That is why he become poor, that we, through his poverty, might become rich. (Deut. 30:9, Deut. 8:18, Phil. 4:19, 2 Cor. 9:8-11) But God has method of making people wealthy as revealed clearly in Joshua 1:8, 3 John 2. he brings material prosperity as the soul prospers by word of God. True riches does not come over night.

God usually passes the man/woman through phases – often called wilderness experience - for his/her own good, before true riches come (Phil. 4: 10-13, Deut. 8:2-9). After this process, the soul is so detached from the love of money/wealth that when it comes he/she can still serve God. Note that in all this, hard work is woven intricately into the person's life. Wealth gathered outside these principles amounts to wealth not by right.

Unrighteous Means of Getting Riches.

1. **Alliance with Satan and Satan worship.** Matt 4:8-10, Luke 4-8. This is the principle behind all satanic worship/ alliance for wealth. See also. Jer. 44:7-18 and note the consequences in Jer: 44:25-28; deaths and ultimate poverty note in Vs.7 that this death affects the whole family and leaves the family with no posterity.
2. **Innocent blood for money.** This is closely related to the above Prov. 1:10-19. Here innocent blood is traded for gain by greedy people. In vs. 18 it is clearly shown that they will ultimately destroy their own lives e.g. Judas. Matt. 27:3-8. This is the trap medical practitioners often fall into. The child in the womb is a human being, the work of the Lord's hand (Ps. 139:13-19, Jer. 1:4-5, Gal. 1:15). Killing that child in the womb is shedding innocent blood for money. **Flee abortion!**
3. **Slavery.** Joel 3: 3-8, Amos 8:6-7.

Communities/families that engaged or still engage in this produce children that will become servants and cannot prosper.

4. **Sharp business practices.** Prov. 11:18, Prov. 20: 10- 11, Amos 8:4-7, Hosea 12:7-9. In Lev. 6:1-6, God sternly warns against fraudulent business practices. He roars punishment and pronounces curses on those who do them. Here He condemns perjury and abuse of trust.
5. **Borrowing and not repaying.** Ps. 37:21. God calls this wickedness.
6. **Stealing and obtaining by deceit.** Lev. 19: 11-14.
7. **Official corruption and bribery.** Isa 7:22-24, Ez. 22:12-24.
8. **Robbing the employer.** Luke 6:1, 10-12. Here the lord teaches that those who do that will have their own. Never rob your employer, public or private, to start a business. That business will not prosper.
9. **Withholding the wages of the worker.** prov. 11:24, James 5:1-61
10. **Using the ministry of the gospel of Jesus Christ as a means to a mass wealth.** 1 Tim 6:3-10.
11. **The love of a dog.** Lev. 19:29, Deut. 23:17-19. Prostitution never prospers.

Consequences of riches not by right

Some have been mentioned already.

1. Eternal damnation in hell. - 1 Tim. 6:7-11, 1 Cor. 6:9-11.
2. Premature deaths. - Prov. 21:6, 22:22-23.
3. Brings a curse into the house which will ultimately destroy the family. Zech. 5: 1-4, Prov. 15:27.
4. Such riches will definitely develop wings and fly away. - Prov. 13:11, 22:16, 23:4-6, Jer. 17:11, Job 15:15-27-29, Job 20:15-19.
5. Block the true blessing and riches which God wants to give. The accuser finds ground to stand. James 5:2-6, Luke 16:10-12.

Note: here in James that bad money has a voice which cries out continually for judgment and blocks true riches from coming.

6. Such riches impoverish others in society and create a poverty stricken society. Amos 8:4-7, James 5:2-6, Isa. 5:8-10.

What shall we do?

A classic example of how each person who has gotten riches not by right should respond to the gospel is seen in Luke 19:5-9:

1. Zaccheous acknowledged his wickedness and need for repentance.
2. Repented humbly before the Lord.
3. Pledged to restore all he has gotten by dubious means
Note that it was only at this point that the Lord said "salvation has come to his house".
Note also salvation came to the house of Zaccheous, not just Zaccheous. See, Ezk. 33: 14-16. Any house that harbors illicit wealth is under a curse (Zech. 5:1-4) and is in need of salvation.
4. Zaccheaus then committed himself to live a holy life, applying the right principles in getting wealth. Go and do likewise. Zach. 8:16-17. Amen.

Conclusion

Riches obtained through unrighteous means always lead to a bad end, for the rich man, his offspring and other beneficiaries. On the other hand, riches properly acquired bring glory to God and blessing to all concerned and the generations after them.

THE MAKING OF A PROPHET

A Prophet As Called:

The ministry of a prophet, like every other ministry is developed in the Old Testament. At the beginning the prophet was called a seer, because he could see the vision of God: Later, he was called a prophet because apart from seeing visions, he prophesied, i.e. Preaches and Foretell, Predicts God's word

1 Sam. 9:9. In the New Testament the prophet gives people a constructive, encouraging and comforting message. Prophecy also affects people and circumstances.

The Call of a Prophet.

Examples of people who were called into the office of a prophet.

- (1). Ezekiel as a priest was called into the office of a prophet. Ezekiel 1:3; 2:1-5)
- (2). Jeremiah, the priest also had the call in the office of prophets. Jer. 1:1 - 10.
- (3). Elisha was called as a farmer into the ministry of prophets. 1 Kings 19:16, 19-21,
- (4). Another farmer, Amos was called as prophet Amos 7:14-5.
- (5). According to Jesus' promise that he would send the church prophets, he poured out his spirit upon the church to among other things raise prophets. You are children of the prophets Matt. 23:24: Acts 2:16-18.
- (6). You can be called into this office, it is one of the inheritance of the church Acts.3:25.

The Preparation and Training of a Prophet.

In Preparing and Training those He called into ministries. God does this by precept and practice. The ministry of the prophet is no exception.

In vision Jeremiah was prepared through personal message (Jer. 1:4-10) and a practical test of this vision (Jer. 1:11-16).

Ezekiel saw the vision of God (Ez. 1), ate the scroll of the vision (Ez.2 S-10;3:1-3) and was filled and bore along by the Holy Spirit (Ez. 2:1-3; 3:4-27).

Observe the flow in communication between God and Ezekiel.

In the school of prophets, they were taught:

- (1).God's word (Isa. 6:16-18; John. 5:45: 1 Pet. 1:10-12).
- (2).Music (1 Sam. 10.5-6; 1 Kings 3:15)
- (3).Anointing and prophesying (1 Sam 19:20-2:2 kings. 9:1-10)
- (4).Holiness (Acts. 3:21; 2 Pet. 1:21),
- (5).Obedience (Isa 20; Hosea, 1:2-4),
- (6).Perseverance (2 kings. 2:1-14,1 Kings 13.41-46),
- (7).Suffering (Matt. 5:12)

Marked the lives of every true prophet.

The Ministry of the Prophets.

Prophets are raised by God to, among other things

Bring back God's people from backsliding. 1 Kings 18.37, Lk. 1:16,17.

Show a spiritual pathway and direction to God's people. Jer. 6:16; Isa. 55:8, 9; Jn.14:6.

Deliver God's people from slavery and bondage Acts. 26:16-18. Hos. 12:10-13: Sam. 7:12-14

Restore all things and bring time of refreshing I.e. revival in the church. Acts. 3:18-26; Isa. 49:1-9

To root out, pull down, throw down, destroy, build and plant. Jer. 1:10,17-19; 25:12-32.

He appoints kings over nations 1 Sam. 16. 1 Kings 19:15-17; Isa. 44:27-45; Jer. 1:10.

He feeds or shepherds God's flock and heals the sick Eph.4:11-13; 1Cor. 14:29-32; 1 kings 5.

Through the call of God, dedication to his ministry and anointing of the Holy Spirit. Prophets stand before God they discharge their ministry faithfully not minding prosecutions from men.

“the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the holy spirit be with us all, now and ever more Amen”